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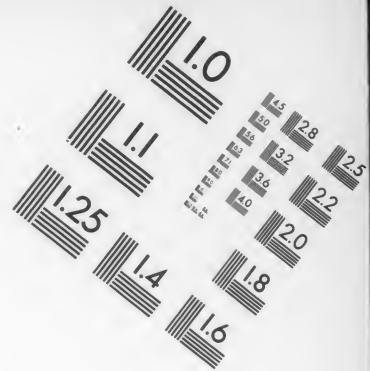
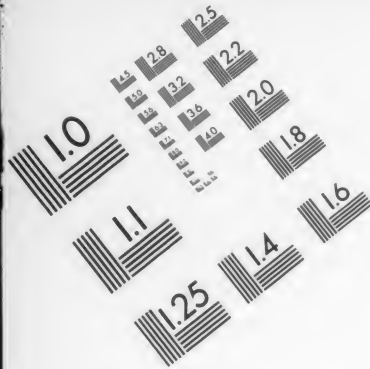
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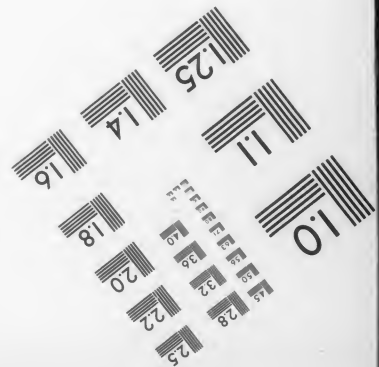
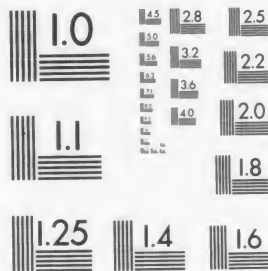
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Submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the degree of Doctor
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THE CULTS OF OLBIA.

PART I.

THE object of the present essay is to bring together whatever fragments of evidence we possess which may throw light upon the cults of Olbia, the colony founded by the Milesians at the mouth of the Borysthenes about 647 B.C.¹ But by way of preface it may be worth while briefly to indicate the claims that Olbia has to be the subject of special study. All the Greek settlements on the North coast of the Euxine must have had in common many



FIG. 1.—MAP OF THE DISTRICT ROUND OLBIA.
(After Latyshev.)

traits which marked them off from Greek colonies elsewhere, but Olbia, while in many respects it may be regarded as a typical city of the locality, was also undoubtedly possessed of an individuality of its own. Though not actually the most northerly of all Greek settlements, which distinction belongs

¹ So Eusebius (Hieron.). Cp. Busolt, *Gr. Gesch.* ii.² p. 483, note 4. Holm (*History of Greece*, English trans., i. 206), says: 'The dates of the founding of the eastern colonies [of Miletus] require fresh investigation.' The date above given may however be considered as approximately correct. See Strabo, vii. 306.

to Tanais, at the mouth of the river of the same name, yet Olbia so far outstripped Tanais in importance that it may fairly be regarded as the most northerly point where Greek civilization attained to an imposing height. That such a height was reached at Olbia is clear from the narrative of Herodotus, as well as from the other sources within our reach. Greek civilization under a northern sky must have meant something quite different from what it did in the Southern Mediterranean: can we at this distance of time find out in what this difference consisted, and obtain an idea of the citizens of Olbia at all approaching in vividness that which we possess of the inhabitants of the Greek islands or of Sicily? Probably this is an ideal which cannot be realised, but the problem is interesting enough to attract attempts at solution. Beloch's theory² that true Greek colonisation was impossible in a district where the olive and vine either did not exist or flourished only in sheltered places, and that nothing but bitter want or desire of commercial gain could make Greeks go so far from their southern home, is surely untenable, at least in the extreme form in which he states it. It is true that Herodotus³ mentions the extreme rigour of the winter, but he also⁴ speaks with enthusiasm of the beauty and productiveness of the Borysthenes, and its basin. From Herodotus, of course, we get a description of the material value of the soil, rather than of the scenic loveliness of the river, but from a modern traveller we may take a sentence or two to illustrate the beauty as well as the commercial importance of the Borysthenes:—

"After having spread out to the breadth of nearly a league, it [the Dnieper, i.e., the Borysthenes] parts into a multitude of channels that wind through forests of oaks, alders, poplars, and aspens, whose vigorous growth bespeaks the richness of a virgin soil. The groups of islands, capriciously breaking the surface of the waters, have a melancholy beauty and a primitive character scarcely to be seen except in those vast wildernesses where man has left no traces of his presence."⁵

The last sentence almost of necessity calls up the Thousand Islands, and in natural sequence, Quebec and the other Canadian settlements even further north, where so many Frenchmen spent their lives, and became the founders of colonial families. If Frenchmen, who are proverbially unwilling colonists, settled in Quebec, surely it cannot be thought impossible that Milesians and other Greeks should have made their homes in Olbia, which, though in almost the same latitude as Quebec, has a less rigorous climate, (compare the "forests of oak and poplar" with the stunted growth of trees and bushes on the lower St. Lawrence), and could be reached by a coasting voyage, instead of by a journey across the open Atlantic. Must not allowance be made for the adventurous element in the character of the Greek, which made the unlikeness of the new lands to his distant home only an additional attraction? Doubtless the typical Athenian would not have stayed contentedly in

² *Gr. Gesch.* i. 194, 5.

³ *iv.* 28.

⁴ *iv.* 58.

⁵ *Travels of Madame de Hottel*, p. 56, quoted by Rawlinson, on Herod. *iv.* 53.

Olbia, any more than the typical Parisian in Quebec, but we cannot predicate Athenian tastes of all Greeks. Beloch's further statement of the backwardness of the cities on the north coast of the Euxine in art and literature may also be found to require modification. Herodotus'⁶ description of the palace of Scyles at Olbia, surrounded by sphinxes and griffins in white marble, certainly does not suggest an indifference to the art of sculpture; and the discovery among the ruins of Olbia of a base which may possibly have belonged to a statue by Praxiteles⁷ points in the same direction. Reference may also be made to Xenophon's mention of the books carried to the north coast of the Euxine in Greek ships;⁸ though, perhaps, if the artistic status of the whole district is called in question, it may be sufficient to refer to the discoveries made in the tombs at Kertsch, on the site of the ancient Panticapaeum; and to the extraordinarily beautiful series of coins issued by that city.

This may suffice to show that Olbia was a Greek city with characteristics distinct enough to entitle it to be the subject of investigation in many lines of research; the present discussion will be confined to its cults, to the consideration of which we will now proceed.

The materials at hand for a study of the cults of Olbia may be classed under four heads:—(1) inscriptions, (2) coins, (3) works of art, etc., which have been dug up near the site of the ancient Olbia or in the district, (4) references in literature. All these materials, however, while comparatively speaking abundant for the later period of the city's history—the period after its destruction by the Getae, circa 65–60 B.C., and its subsequent rebuilding—are extremely scanty for the earlier times, when a knowledge of the cults would be of such value in the study of Greek religion in general, and of its aspect in the various colonies in particular.

The first question to be discussed is the relation if any, between the religion of the first settlers at Olbia and that of their Scythian neighbours. Did they from the beginning adapt the deities and legends of Sarmatia to the needs of Greek civic worship, or did they set out from Miletus under the special auspices of Apollo, and derive their religion mainly from that of the mother city, while, with the eclecticism inherent in Greek religion, they domesticated in their own town the gods of states with which they had frequent intercourse? Any attempt at the solution of this problem must rely upon a detailed examination of the separate cults, so far as any record of them has come down to us; but one of the cults is so important to this enquiry that a determination of its origin must be attempted even at this preliminary stage.

The cult of Achilles Pontarches was ancient and widespread over the whole district of the North Euxine. The island of Leuke was the special

⁶ Herod. *iv.* 79.

⁷ Latyshev, *Inscr. Antig. Orae Septentr. Pont. Eux.* i. 145. Loewy, *Inscr. Gr. Bildhauer*, 76*. P. 383, quotes this inscription from Latyshev, and approves the identification. He notes that Pliny (*N.H.* xxxvi. 22), mentions

an Eros of Praxiteles at Parion in the Propontis. The letters of this inscription are of the fourth century B.C. Cp. Lat. *iv.* 82, a marble basis from Chersonesus, inscribed Πολυκράτης ἐποίησε, with Latyshev's note.

⁸ Xenophon, *Anab.* vii. 5, 14.

sanctuary of this worship, but at Olbia also Achilles held a most important place. We have a witness to the existence of this cult on the Euxine as early as the end of the seventh or the beginning of the sixth century B.C. in Alcaeus⁹:—'Ἀχιλλεύς δ' ἦν Σκυθίῃς μέδεις. His worship at Leuke was familiar to Pindar,—

ἐν δ' Εὐξείνῳ πελάγει φαεινὸν Ἀχιλεὺς
ναῖον (ἔχει).¹⁰

What was the origin of this early localisation of Achilles on the Black Sea?

Koehler¹¹ thinks that the early Milesian settlers found the cult of Achilles already firmly established among the natives of the land where they settled, and that they adopted it from them. It is difficult to see what can be adduced in support of this theory, and a good many points may be advanced in opposition.

In the first place Herodotus¹² says that the only gods worshipped by the Scythians are Hestia first of all, then Zeus and the Earth, then Apollo and Aphrodite Ourania, and Herakles and Ares.

Surely Herodotus would not have omitted to mention Achilles, if he had been a prominent object of worship, especially as he does mention Herakles. The fact that he does not speak of a cult of Achilles at Olbia is not of course germane to the argument; he makes no attempt (unluckily for us) to describe the Greek colonies on the Euxine, which he could assume were familiar to his public; but he gives a very full description of Scythian manners and customs, and one which is generally accepted as being correct in essentials. We owe the charming little picture he has given us of Olbia¹³ to its connection with the fate of the Scythian king Scyles, and the references to its cults, though very valuable as far as they go, are merely incidental.

In the second place, is it reasonable to credit the Scythians and other barbarian tribes on the North shores of the Euxine with an intimate acquaintance with the exploits of Achilles, or with a desire to erect him into a deity? Such a theory seems entirely out of harmony with all we know of the character and religion of these nations. Even if we suppose the Scythians to have deified a native hero of their own, whom the Greeks identified with Achilles, (a theory which is not very tenable, for the history of Achilles was peculiarly distinctive), we should not have advanced far in support of Koehler's theory, for why should the Greeks have forthwith adopted the cult unless Achilles and the Black Sea had been already closely associated in their minds? We must remember that we have not here to deal with an almost immediate amalgamation of the Greek settlers with the natives, such as took place in Magna Graecia; we see from Herodotus' account, nearly 150 years after the founding of Olbia, how alien the customs of the Scythians

⁹ Bergk, *Lyrici Gr.* 48. B, quoted by Eustath. *ad Dionys. Per.* 306.

¹⁰ *Nem.* iv. 49.

¹¹ *Mémoires sur les îles et la course consacrées à Achille dans le Pont Euxin.* St. Pétersbourg,

1827. (*Mémoires de l'Acad. Imp. des Sciences, Sér. v. vol. x.*)

¹² iv. 59.

¹³ iv. 78, 79.

were felt to be by the Greeks. Another indication of race-feeling is supplied by the vase-paintings found on the north Euxine.¹⁴ Here Scyths (if we are to call them by this name) of purely Russian type occur, taming horses, or in company with the griffins with which Greek fancy peopled the steppes to the north. The conjunction of these with the purely Greek figures in the mythological scenes on these vases seems to indicate a complete race-separation. The fact that Herodotus mentions that Scyles married a Greek wife at Olbia tends to confirm this view; for if intermarriage had been very common, it would hardly have been worth while to refer to it.

As far as we can tell, Arctinus, the Milesian poet, in his epic the 'Aethiopis,' was the earliest Greek author to place the home of Achilles after death on the island of Leuke. Now Arctinus is usually assigned to the eighth century B.C., which is earlier than the accepted dates for the founding of the Milesian colonies on the Black Sea. Accepting for the moment both these dates, we may none the less conjecture that by the end of the eighth century B.C. Milesian adventurers were already making trial of the Euxine, where the almost complete absence of islands would render Leuke a grateful memory to the Greek sailor, and a prominent feature in his sea-stories. Here was material ready to Arctinus' hand, just as the 'still-vexed Bermoothes' of some sailor's yarn furnished a stage-setting for Shakespeare more than 2,400 years later. But it is not even necessary to suppose as much as this: if Milesians were already beginning to make voyages eastward, a Milesian poet would be very likely to set the abode of Achilles in the dimly-known Euxine. The Isles of the Blest and Elysium were already interchangeable terms;¹⁵ and it was not unnatural for a patriotic poet, to whom it may have been already clear that the expansion of his native state was to take place eastward, to place a Blessed Isle in the eastern sea, and thus put the colonisation of his city under the protection of a tutelary deity. The name *Λευκίη* rather suggests the fairy tale; later travellers have explained it by the flocks of sea-birds on its shores; but this scarcely seems enough to warrant the name; whereas if the island Leuke already existed in story, an identification with the island off the mouth of the Ister was almost inevitable, as there are practically no others in the Black Sea.

It is not, however, certain that the date of Arctinus is as early as the eighth century B.C. If his date can be set later, the eastward trend of his story is easy of explanation. Holm¹⁶ assigns the founding of Sinope to the eighth century, apparently following the statement of Eusebius that Trapezus, a colony of Sinope, was founded in Olymp. 6, 1. (756 B.C.). This date Beloch¹⁷ considers too early; he gives 630 B.C. as the date of the founding of Sinope. In any case the beginnings of Milesian adventure in the Euxine may be almost certainly assigned to the lifetime of Arctinus. Mr. D. B.

¹⁴ Stephani, *Compte-Rendu* (passim); *Antiq. du Bosp. Cimm.*, Pl. 45, 46 (vase of Xenophantos).

¹⁵ Pauly-Wissowa, *Real-Enycl.* i., p. 240.

¹⁶ *Greek Hist.* (Engl. transl.), i. chap. xxi.

p. 275.

¹⁷ *Gr. Gesch.* i. chap. vi. p. 193, note 2; Busolt, *Gr. Gesch.* ii. 2, p. 482; Strabo, xii. 546.

Monro¹⁸ regards the fact that a Milesian poet is the first to make Leuke the abode of Achilles as significant of the important part played by Miletus in diffusing Greek religious ideas through the Black Sea region. The choice of Leuke serves to 'connect the "Aethiopsis" with the time when the Ionian trading cities, of which Miletus was the chief, had begun to adopt the new religious practices that grew up, after the Homeric age, in honour of the national heroes.' Welcker¹⁹ takes a similar view and quotes Bernhardt (ii. 153): 'The apotheosis of the hero at Leuke betrays the Milesian poet.'

It is worth while to notice here the significance of the companion assigned to Achilles at Leuke, variously named as Medea, Iphigeneia, and Helen. The last²⁰ is apparently the latest in date of the tales, and has no importance here; it must have arisen in an age that had begun to criticise the Homeric stories, and to feel that the noblest of heroes and the fairest of women must be united after death, even though they had been separated in life. The oldest story seems to be that in which Medea becomes the wife of Achilles, according to the scholiast on Apollonius Rhodius, *Arg.* iv. 814 ὅτι δὲ Ἀχιλλεύς εἰς τὸ Ἠλύσιον πεδίον παραγενόμενος ἔγημε Μήδειαν πρῶτος Ἰβυκος εἶρηκε μεθ' ὃν Σιμωνίδης. Ibycus is usually placed about 560 B.C. It must be noted that Elysium and not Leuke is here made the hero's abode, so that unless we may suppose that Achilles' part of Elysium was already localised at Leuke, we cannot press the argument too far; but it is tempting to conjecture that Achilles and Medea were placed side by side as the two semi-divine personages most closely connected with the Euxine. Colonisation in the Euxine had by this time been in progress for almost a hundred years, and Achilles was already its tutelary deity. The country of Medea and the Golden Fleece was supposed to lie to the far East, so, as the Black Sea was gradually opened up, the Argonautic myths inevitably attached themselves to its shores, for no other sea lay in this direction.²¹ The story of the voyage of the Argo was already familiar to the author of the *Odyssey*—

οἷη δὲ κείνη γε παρέπλω ποντοπόρος νηὺς
'Αργὼ πᾶσι μέλουσα, παρ' Αἰήταο πλέουσα,²²

but here the direction is westward, if east and west can be said to exist in fairy-land.

It is more difficult to assign a date to the story of Achilles' connection at Leuke with Iphigeneia—the most satisfactory bride for him from the modern point of view. The tale was elaborated by Lycophron, but so late an author has little value in the present enquiry. The 'Kypria' (776 B.C. circa) seems to be the source of the story that Artemis carried away Iphigeneia to the Tauri, leaving a hind to be sacrificed at Aulis in her stead (Proclus, *περὶ τῶν Κυπρίων*, p. 475, *ap.* Gaisford, Hephaest. Ἀρτεμὶς δὲ αὐτὴν ἐξαρπάσασα εἰς Ταύρους μετακομίζει καὶ ἰθάναντον ποιεῖ· ἔλαφον δὲ ἀντὶ τῆς κόρης παρίστησι τῷ βομῷ). The story of the substitution was, however, either

¹⁸ *Journal of Hellenic Studies* (1884), vol. 5,

p. 16.

¹⁹ *Der Ep. Cyclops*, ii. p. 221.

²⁰ Pausan., iii. 19, 11.

²¹ See Holm, i. p. 117.

²² *Odyssey*, xii. 69, 70.

unknown to or ignored by Aeschylus,²³ Sophocles,²⁴ and Pindar²⁵; perhaps it was considered as an unauthorized version of the myth, to which Euripides, perceiving its dramatic value, first gave wide currency.²⁶ But we have no proof that the story of Iphigeneia's marriage to Achilles after death, and their abode at Leuke, was known to Euripides, unless the words of Achilles to Iphigeneia—

Ἀγαμέμνωνος παῖ, μακάριόν μέ τις θεῶν
ἔμελλε θήσειν, εἰ τύχοιμι σὼν γάμων²⁷—

are to be regarded as an instance of dramatic irony, the final fulfilment of his wish being known to all the spectators. This interpretation is probably far-fetched, but the connection between the two is such a natural one that it is difficult not to suppose that it was already familiar at this date.²⁸

The cult of Achilles at Olbia will have to be discussed later, with such details as the materials at hand allow; the object of the preceding pages is to make it seem probable that the mythical connection of Achilles with the Euxine was purely Greek in its origin, and may even be traced with considerable probability to Miletus, and to the earliest period of Milesian enterprise in the Black Sea, and that it owed nothing to the barbarian dwellers along the sea-shore.

The same theory as to the independence of the religion of Olbia of ideas borrowed from the Scythians seems to be borne out by Herodotus.²⁹ He says that the Scythians had no shrines or images of their gods except of Ares. Moreover, as the 'temple' of Ares was merely of brushwood and his 'image' (τὸ ἄγαλμα) an ancient sword, it seems scarcely necessary to make even this exception. It is hardly conceivable that a religion of this stamp could have had appreciable influence on the cults of pure Greeks, such as the early settlers at Olbia.

It is perhaps already clear that an attempt will be made to present Olbia as a purely Greek city, very little influenced by the barbarous inhabitants of the land, and deriving such foreign elements as appear in its worship rather from its commerce with Asiatic cities than from its neighbours on the European mainland. There are two passages, however, which must be taken into account here,—Herodotus' reference (iv. 17) to the Ἕλληνες Σκύθαι, whom he places in the district just inland from Olbia; and the mention in the Protogenes decree³⁰ of the Μιξέλληνες, who to the number of 1500 had deserted to the enemy. With regard to the former, it seems best to suppose with Stein (*ad loc.*) that they were Scythians who had adopted Greek customs from their trade with the Greek commercial city. Note that Herodotus distinctly places them *outside* the town, and at a distance from it, and that he makes no mention of any mixed element within the city itself. Ditten-

²³ *Agam.* 1390.

²⁴ *Electra*, 531, 2.

²⁵ *Pyth.* xi. 22.

²⁶ Assuming that the latter part of *Iph. in Aul.* is from Euripides' hand.

²⁷ *Iph. in Aul.*, 1405, 6.

²⁸ See Wilamowitz, *Hermes*, xviii. (1883),

250.

²⁹ Herod. iv. 59–62, alluded to above.

³⁰ Latyschev, i. 16, B.

berger³¹ in his note on the *Μεξέλληνες* of the Protogenes decree, considers that both in this place and in Herodotus a mixed race is meant. Certainly the *Μεξέλληνες* must be regarded as such (the name would hardly be possible otherwise) but the date of the Protogenes decree is probably at least 200 years later than Herodotus' visit to Olbia, and the city was already rapidly declining. But even in the decree they are described as *τοὺς τῆμ παρώρειαν οἰκοῦντας*, and nothing leads us to suppose that they were found inside the city, or that they had any share in its government. The names found in the inscriptions are purely Greek, up to the time of the destruction of the city by the Getae. It is interesting here to notice that Dio Chrysostom,³² after describing the miserable state of the Greeks after the destruction of their cities by the Getae, ascribes the rebuilding of Olbia by its former citizens to the invitation of the Scythians, who felt the loss of a market for their products. After the taking of the city, merchants no longer came to Olbia, *ἅτε οὐκ ἔχοντες ὁμοφώνους τοὺς ὑποδεχομένους οὐδὲ αὐτῶν Σκυθῶν ἀξιούντων οὐδὲ ἐπισταμένων ἐμπόριον αὐτῶν κατασκευάσθαι τὸν Ἑλληνικὸν τρόπον*. This at least shows that the Greek language and Greek customs had not diffused themselves over the surrounding peoples, and indirectly supports the converse proposition that the Greeks of Olbia were little influenced by their Scythian neighbours. The relation between the Greeks and the barbarians may be plausibly conjectured to have been not unlike that of the English to the natives in the early days of the settlements in India, before they had any real territorial jurisdiction, and were still in some degree subject to the neighbouring native prince. The Scythian husbandmen, *οἱ οὐκ ἐπὶ σιτήσι σπείρουσι τὸν σίτον ἀλλ' ἐπὶ πρήσι*,³³ brought their grain for sale to Olbia, just as the Hindoo peasant brought his rice or indigo to the factories of the East India Company. So it is as the most northerly outpost of Greek civilization and religion that Olbia will be considered in the present essay.

Apollo.

'Ex diis insignis Apollo *προστάτης*.'—Boeckh, *C.I.G.* ii. p. 87.

From this statement of Boeckh's, which seems justified by the evidence that has come down to us, Apollo would claim the first place in a consideration of the cults of Olbia. It is true that the series of dedicatory inscriptions to Apollo Prostates, given by Latyshev (i. 50-74, iv. 15, 16), belongs to the later period of the city (none is earlier than the second or third centuries A.D.), but there are two other inscriptions to Apollo of a much earlier period.³⁴ One (Lat. i. 93) is assigned to the fourth century B.C.; it is fragmentary

ΚΗΙΟΞΟ/
ΤΟΛΛΩΝΗ

³¹ *Sylloge*, 2 226.

³² *Orat.* xxxvi.

³³ Herod. iv. 17.

³⁴ Also the fragmentary one given by Lat. i.

19, and assigned by him to the second century B.C., which seems to contain the name of Apollo.

Latyshev fills it out as

... κήϊος 'Ο[λβιοπολίτης] (?)
'Απ[όλλωνι] 'Ι[ητρῶι] ?

There seems no doubt here as to the occurrence of the name Apollo; whether *Ἰητρός* is the title to be supplied is of course a matter for conjecture, but it occurs in Panticapaeian inscriptions of the fourth century B.C., and in a Phanagorian one of the third century B.C.³⁵

The other early Olbian inscription referring to Apollo is the dedication to Apollo Delphinios (Lat. i. 106) assigned to the third century B.C.

The evidence of coins indicates clearly the importance of the cult of Apollo at Olbia; from the fourth century B.C. down we have examples of coins bearing his head, probably more in number than those of any other single deity. The Berlin collection, for example, which contains 146 Olbian coins, has over thirty which show representations of Apollo. The origin of the special cult of Apollo at Olbia may be traced back to Miletus, where Apollo was the chief deity, and the natural patron of the numerous colonies sent out; and its persistence at Olbia may have been due to Apollo's connection with the myth of the Hyperboreans, and to the feeling that he was a fitting tutelary deity for the most northerly Greek colony. Both of these points, the derivation of the cult from Miletus, and the relation of Apollo to the North, will be discussed below, in the more detailed examination of the worship of Apollo at Olbia under its different aspects.

The want of early evidence for the cult of Apollo Prostates at Olbia makes the testimony of some Olbian coins of the first century A.D. of the highest value. When in these Olbian Imperial coins we find a type of Apollo which seems clearly that of an archaic statue, we are justified in treating it as at least presumptive evidence of the existence of an early cult. One of these coins is described in the Catalogue of the Berlin Museum,³⁶—

Obverse.

ΟΛΒΙΟΠΟ . . . Youthful head,
right, probably Apollo.
Æ 5.

Reverse.

CATYΔ . . . Naked Apollo standing facing, seemingly with modius or walled-crown, vase in right, large bow with arrow in left.



FIG. 2.—BRONZE COIN OF OLBIA IN THE BERLIN MUSEUM.

See Fig. 2. A similar coin from the Moscow collection is given by B. Pick³⁷ the reverse of which is described as follows:—

³⁵ Lat. ii. 6, 10, 15, 348.

³⁶ *Beschreibung der Antiken Münzen*, Berlin 1888, vol. 1, No. 124 in the series of coins

of Olbia.

³⁷ *Thrakische Münzbilder*, *Jahrbuch d. Deutschen Arch. Instit.*, xiii. (1898), Pl. x. 31.

ΔΑΔΟCCATY. Naked Apollo with calathus standing facing, in his outstretched right a round-shaped object, in the left bow and arrow.

The first point of extraordinary interest about these two coins is the presence of the calathus³⁸ on the head of the god, making it clear that he is here depicted in his character as civic deity. The die-cutter was not in the least likely to have added this unusual attribute, unless he was copying from a well-known statue, of which the calathus was one of the distinguishing marks, without which the type on the coin would not be recognized as a reproduction of the statue. The presence of the calathus Pick thinks alone sufficient to indicate the great antiquity of the original; but, more than this, he regards the figure on the coins as clearly archaic, and thinks it resembles very closely the archaic statuette of Apollo from Naxos³⁹; but he considers it older than the statuette because of the presence of the calathus. He would assign the date of the statue to the beginning, or at any rate the middle, of the sixth century B.C. *i.e.* within the first century of the city's existence; and in any case regards it as certainly earlier than the Didymaeon Apollo of Canachus in the mother-city Miletus. The round object in the right hand Pick explains as perhaps a pomegranate or an ointment-box,—the same attribute which appears in the Naxos statuette; and as a bow appears on the coins in the left hand, he thinks one should also be placed in the left hand of the statuette, especially as the inscription upon it has the epithet *ἐκηβόλος*. The fact that earlier Olbian coins show merely a head of Apollo has of course no bearing on the question of the antiquity of the statue depicted on these Imperial coins, as in the period of best art the die-cutters never merely imitated a statue in their coin-types.⁴⁰

It should be said that Pick only suggests the possibility of identifying this coin-type with Apollo Προστάτης; but, granting his premisses as to the archaic character of the original of the coin-type, the identification seems almost inevitable. There is certainly a difficulty in accounting for the preservation of the statue in the destruction of Olbia by the Getae; but we do not know how complete this destruction was; moreover, if there were really a cult-statue of Apollo Προστάτης it would certainly have been reproduced by numerous statuettes. These, of course, might easily have escaped, and any one of them could have furnished a type for the die-cutter,—the calathus being almost sufficient of itself to point the reference to the statue.

The series of dedicatory inscriptions to Apollo Prostates given by Latyshev,⁴¹ is assigned by him to the second and third centuries A.D. *i.e.* somewhat later than the date assigned by Pick to the coins discussed above. These offerings were all made by the *στρατηγοί* (=praetors) and from the number of inscriptions that remain it has been supposed that the gifts were

³⁸ Through the courtesy of Dr. H. Dressel of the Berlin Museum, I have obtained casts of coin 124 (as well as of others referred to below). From the cast it appears even more clearly than from the illustration given by Pick, that the

head-dress is undoubtedly the calathus.

³⁹ See Roscher's *Lexicon*, i. 1 452.

⁴⁰ P. Gardner, *Types of Greek Coins*, p. 68, *et seq.*

⁴¹ Lat. i. 50-74, iv. 15, 16.

made yearly. The last lines of No. 50 may be quoted to illustrate the usual formula with which they conclude:—

ἀνέθηκαν φιέλην ἀργυρᾶν ὑπὲρ τῆς πόλεως εὐσταθίας καὶ τῆς ἐαυτῶν υἰείας.

Other articles presented are a golden necklace, a silver Nike, a golden Nike on a silver base, &c. In No. 58 instead of the usual gifts, the praetors repaired the roof and wall of the temple of Apollo:

ἐπεσκεύασαν τοῦ Ἀπόλλωνος ἱ[α]οῦ τὴν τε ὀροφὴν [κ]αὶ [κ]ύκλωθεν τὰ ἐνλε[π]οντα [κ]αινίσαντες ὑπὲρ τῆς πόλεως [κ]αὶ τῆς ἐαυτῶν υἰείας.

Below this last inscription is an epigram addressing Apollo as *τοξότα Φοῖβε*, apparently commemorating some victory. No. 61 similarly refers to the repairing of the temple:—

ἀνέθηκαν Νείκην χρύ[σ]εον ὑπὲρ τῆς πόλεως καὶ τῆς ἐαυτῶν υἰείας. Ἐπὶ τοῖς αὐτοῖς ἐπεσκεύασ[θησαν] αἱ στοαὶ τοῦ ναοῦ ἐ[κ] τοῦ δη[μο]σίου πόρου.⁴²

These inscriptions make it impossible to doubt that Apollo Προστάτης was the city-deity of Olbia in the later period; and from the permanence of Greek state-cults, as well as from the evidence of the coins given above, it seems reasonable to believe that the earliest colonists brought with them from Miletus this cult, of special appropriateness for those who were going to found a city in a new land. For the title Προστάτης is of kindred meaning to that of Ἀγνιεύς, given to Apollo as the protector of those who went in and out of the house. In this aspect Apollo was represented by a conical block of stone standing before the door.⁴³ (On a coin given in figure 3,⁴⁴ referred to below, Apollo appears with his left elbow resting upon a pillar). Is it too much to conjecture that the early colonists of Olbia brought with them a small column of this kind as their representation of Apollo, which served as the cult image until the production of the statue postulated by Pick as the original of the standing figure in the coin-type?⁴⁵ Hesychius, under *προστατήριος*, explains the word by the custom of placing a statue (or pillar) of Apollo before the house door, *ὅτι πρὸ τῶν θυρῶν ἱδρύται*. Whether this derivation will stand or not, there can be no

⁴² It may be noted here that it is from the last two words of this inscription that the title, otherwise unknown, of Apollo Ithyperos has been evolved. Boeckh *C.I.G.* 2072, reads the last eight letters of the inscription as *ΙΘΥΠΟΡΟΥ*. Latyshev, in his comments on this inscription, points out that the dedication is to Apollo Προστάτης, and adds, 'Jam igitur valere jubeamus necesse est Apollinem illum Ithyperum, qui Koehlero duce in omnes libros et commentationes de Olbia scriptas irrepsit.'

⁴³ For references to stones or representations

of deities, see Frazer's note on Paus. x. 16, 3; and for Apollo in particular, Aristoph. *Wasps*. 875. These representations not infrequently occur on coins, *e.g.* coin of Ambrakia: Head, *Hist. Num.*, p. 270, fig. 181; and coin of Megara, Imhoof-Blumer and Gardner, *Num. Comm. on Paus.*, J.H.S., vi. (1885) p. 55. Also Evans, *Myc. Treas. and Pillar Cult*, J.H.S. xxi. (1901) i. p. 173, fig. 49.

⁴⁴ No. 135 in Berlin Catalogue.

⁴⁵ See Prof. P. Gardner, *Countries and Cities in Anc. Art*, J.H.S. ix. (1888) p. 51.

doubt that the titles of Ἀγνιεύς and Προστάτης present the god under substantially the same aspect. Compare the Delphic oracle quoted by Demosthenes⁴⁶ περὶ ὑγείας θύειν καὶ εὐχεσθαι Διὶ ὑστάτῳ, Ἡρακλεῖ, Ἀπόλλωνι προστατήριον· περὶ τύχας ἀγαθὰς Ἀπόλλωνι ἀγνιεύϊ, Δατοῖ, Ἀρτέμιδι, καὶ κατ' ἀγνιάς κρατήρας ἰστάμεν,⁴⁷ and again in the oracle from Dodona quoted in the same passage occur the words Ἀπόλλωνι ἀποτροπαίῳ βούν θύσαι. It is worth while to notice the correspondence between περὶ ὑγείας in the oracle and ὑπὲρ τῆς ἐαντῶν ὑγείας in the dedicatory inscriptions of the praetors to Apollo Prostates, quoted above.

The actual title of Prostates occurs in Soph. *Trach.* 209 :—

ἐν δὲ
κοινὸς ἀρσένων ἵτω
κλαγγὰ τὸν εὐφάρετραν
Ἀπόλλω προστατάν.

In the *Electra*, l. 637 Clytemnestra invokes Apollo as Φοῖβε Προστατήριε, a name given also to Artemis in Aesch. *Septem*, 449 προστατηρίας Ἀρτέμιδος εὐνοίαισι. Paus. i. 44, 2 mentions a temple of Apollo under this title at Megara (cp. the name Προστάσια applied to Demeter, Paus. ii. 11. 3). At Athens offerings were made to Apollo Προστατήριος and Artemis βουλαία before the meeting of the ecclesia.⁴⁸ Notice also the reference to Artemis in an inscription from Chersonesus,⁴⁹ ἡ διὰ παντὸς Χερσονησιτῶν προστατοῦσα Παρθένος. Preller-Robert⁵⁰ may be quoted here: 'nicht selten ist Apollon Agyieus aber auch ein Symbol der städtischen Ansiedlung.' Such we may conjecture Apollo Prostates to have been at Olbia; and we may accept the crude representation of the god wearing the calathus upon the Imperial coin as the only representation of him as the tutelary deity of Olbia that has come down to us. The fragmentary early inscription which may be to Apollo Ἰητροῦς has been already quoted. It cannot be pressed as evidence that this cult actually existed at Olbia, but it is likely enough that it did, for we have inscriptions from Panticapaeum and Phanagoria (referred to above), where Apollo is given this title.⁵¹ The name Apollo Ἰατροῦς occurs on two coins, one described by von Sallet⁵² and another by Lambros,⁵³ given by Pick.⁵⁴ These have been assigned to Asia Minor, but Pick thinks they belong to Apollonia on the Black Sea, together with some other coins which he gives,⁵⁵ and this attribution is now accepted by all numismatists. Von Sallet's coin has a laureate head of Apollo as obverse type. The reverse is thus described :—

⁴⁶ *Meid.* 531.

⁴⁷ An Attic monument quoted by Welcker (*Gr. Götterlehre*, vol. i. p. 496), links these titles, *C.I.G.*, 465.

⁴⁸ *C.I.A.* ii. 390, 392, 408, 417, 431, 432, 459.

⁴⁹ *Lat.* i. 185.

⁵⁰ *Gr. Myth.* i. 1 p. 276, sq.

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⁵² *Zeitschr. f. Num.* 5, 108.

⁵³ *Bull. Corr. Hell.* 2, 508, 2.

⁵⁴ *Jahrbuch*, loc. cit. Pl. x. 29, 30.

⁵⁵ loc. cit. Pl. x. 26-28.

'Naked Apollo standing facing and looking left, right leaning on a long branch, in lowered left a bow and arrow.'

The coin given by Lambros is similar, but with full inscription. Pick says that the material of these two coins is like that of the coins of Mesembria, near Apollonia. The other three coins with which he compares these two, and which he thinks certainly belong to Apollonia, all have an anchor as the obverse type, and a standing figure of Apollo as the reverse.

One of these may be quoted, which Pick dates in the first half of the second century B.C. On the obverse is an anchor. The reverse is described as follows:

Naked Apollo, standing facing, a bough in his outstretched right, in his lowered left a bow and two arrows, right perhaps leaning on pillar.

Now we know that when Lucullus sacked Apollonia in 72 B.C. he took away a colossal statue of Apollo, the work of Calamis, and placed it at Rome.⁵⁶ No coins of Apollonia with this Apollo-type are certainly known, though on Imperial coins a temple often appears, with a standing naked Apollo as cult-statue inside. As the three anchor coins belong to the first half of the second century B.C. and as the archaic Apollo-type could not belong to that period, Pick thinks that the figure represented may very likely be that of the colossal statue by Calamis. The existence of a cult of Apollo Ἰητροῦς at Apollonia has been recently proved by an inscription of the early Roman period,⁵⁷ κτίσας τὴν πόλιν μετὰ τὴν ἑκτῶσιν Ἀπόλλωνι Ἰητρ[ῶ]. The laurel bough is regarded as the attribute of Apollo under this aspect; this cannot certainly be proved; however, it occurs in all five of the coins mentioned above; and at Panticapaeum, though no full length figure of the god occurs on coins, a relief has been found in which Apollo has a long laurel branch.⁵⁸ This relief is assigned by Reinach to the period of Calamis; it is of importance here because the name Ἰητροῦς occurs oftener at Panticapaeum than anywhere else. To return to Olbia: No. 135 in the Berlin catalogue has the following obverse type :—

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Appian, *Illyr.* 30.

⁵⁷ Dumont, *Mé. d' Arch.* p. 459, n. 111, d 7.

⁵⁸ *Monuments et Mémoires*, Fond. Piot.

⁵⁹ *Die Antiken Münzen Nord-Griechenlands*, i. 1, Pl. xi. 20.

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⁵⁸ *Monuments et Mémoires*, Fond. Piot.

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⁵⁹ *Die Antiken Münzen Nord-Griechenlands*, i. 1, Pl. xi. 20.

Certainly it is impossible to state positively that a cult of Apollo Ἰηρός existed at Olbia, from the dubious evidence of a coin and a fragmentary



FIG. 3.—BRONZE COIN OF OLBIA IN THE BERLIN MUSEUM.

inscription, but doubtful as they are, one may fairly make the most of them, considering the prevalence of the cult on the north shores of the Black Sea.

The name of Apollo Delphinios occurs in an inscription given by Latyshev I, 106, and assigned by him to the third century, B.C.:

Ἀγρότας καὶ Ποσίδεος οἱ ἀδελφοὶ τὸν πατέρα Διονύσιον [Ἀπ]όλλωνι Δελφινίῳ ἱερησάμενον.

This is all the definite evidence that exists as to the cult of Apollo Delphinios at Olbia. A fish-type (the identification of which is discussed below under Demeter), occurs very commonly on Olbian coins as a reverse type, but frequently with deities other than Apollo on the obverse; and as it has usually an eagle standing upon it and pecking at it, it seems scarcely possible to take it as a symbol of Apollo Delphinios. However, it appears by itself on some coins,⁶⁰ also in coin No. 73 of the Berlin collection, with Apollo as the obverse type, and it may possibly have been the attribute of the god under this aspect, though a commercial explanation seems more probable. The cult was widespread. Strabo (iv. 179) in speaking of the cult of Apollo Delphinios at Massilia, says: τοῦτο μὲν κοινὸν Ἰώνων ἀπάντων, and Plutarch *de sollertia anim.* 984 A, says: καὶ μὲν Ἀρτέμιδος γε Δικτύνης Δελφινίῳ τε Ἀπόλλωνος ἱερὰ καὶ βωμοὶ παρὰ πολλοῖς Ἑλλήνων εἰσίν. The name appears in several inscriptions; two may be mentioned here, both belonging to the third century B.C. like the Olbian one, and both from Knossos in Crete, *C.I.G.*, 2554, and Cauer, *Del.* 121. A month Delphinios, probably corresponding to the Attic Anthesterion, is known at Aegina, Crete, and Thera.⁶¹

As Delphinios, Apollo was the god who gave fair weather to the mariner, and was therefore likely to be a special object of worship at Olbia, whose wealth and prosperity depended on maritime trade. The title may be compared with that of Ἐπιβατήριος, under which name Apollo had a temple at Troezen⁶² and Ἐμβάσιος, to whom the Argonauts set up an altar, according to Apoll. Rhod. i. 402.

For the existence at Olbia of representations of the griffin, a creature specially attached to the cult of Apollo, we have evidence much earlier than

any of the coins or inscriptions cited above, namely, from Herodotus himself, who, in describing the palace of Scyles at Olbia (iv. 79) says: τὴν πέριξ λευκοῦ λίθου σφίγγες τε καὶ γρύπες ἔστασαν. Griffins occur constantly in vase-paintings found in the North Euxine district; the most famous of these is the well-known vase of Xenophantos already referred to, where the bodies of the griffins are blue and the horns and part of the wings gilded. This was found near Panticapaeum in 1836.⁶³ The griffins on the coins of Panticapaeum are of course familiar. Mr. A. J. Evans⁶⁴ traces back the connection of griffins and the sun-god to the Egyptian solar cycle. He gives Mycenaean gems and cylinders upon which a pair of griffins appear as heraldic supporters of the sacred column—the divine pyramidal stone which, as we have seen, persists as an emblem of Apollo in his character of Agyieus down to a late date.

Hesiod was the first to treat of griffins, according to the scholiast on Aesch. Prom. 803 (οἱ γρύπες) περὶ ὧν Ἡσίοδος πρῶτος ἑτεραπεύσατο, but we do not know in what poem. As he also wrote about the Hyperboreans, it is possible that even as early as this griffins were supposed to live in the north. We know more of the poem of Aristaeas of Proconnesus (early sixth century B.C.?) from Herodotus iv. 13–15, a passage of great importance in this connection. Herodotus speaks of the poem as τὰ ἔπεα ταῦτα τὰ νῦν ὑπ' Ἑλλήνων Ἀριμάσπεια καλεῖται. According to Suidas the Arimaspeia was a hexameter poem in three books. Dürrbach⁶⁵ says that the Arimaspians apparently belonged to a Scythian myth, and Aristaeas seems to have had the idea of identifying the griffins already known in Greece, with the fabulous animals from whom in the story the Arimaspians stole the gold. But if we follow Mr. Evans in tracing back the connection of the griffin and the sun-god to the very earliest times, we must surely explain the localisation of the griffins in the North Euxine district by the myth of Apollo and the Hyperboreans, which will be referred to below. Sun myths are at present discredited, but the immemorial connection of Apollo and the Hyperboreans (δάμον Ἵπερβορέων . . . Ἀπόλλωνος θεράποντα⁶⁶) can hardly be explained in any other way. Dim accounts of a land where for a part of the year the sun never set must have reached Hellas at a very early period, and the griffins, familiar as the attendants of Apollo in the representations of the god in art, were localised in the unknown land of marvels. Then came Aristaeas, an early Marco Polo, whom we may believe really to have travelled over the countries he described. But the griffins already had their home there, and Aristaeas could not have ousted them even if he had wished to forgo such a picturesque feature of his poem. What he apparently did was to tell the story in the form henceforth accepted as the authorized version. (Note, by the way, the connection of Aristaeas with Apollo as shown by Herodotus' story of his appearance at Metapontum, and injunction to the inhabitants to set up an altar to Apollo and a statue to himself.) The story

⁶⁰ Pick, *loc. cit.*, Pl. ix. 17, 18.

⁶² Paus., ii. 32, 2.

⁶¹ Scholiast on Pindar, *Nem.* v. 81.

⁶³ *Ant. du Bosp. Cim.*, Pl. 45, 46.

⁶⁴ *Myc. Treas. and Pillar Cult.*, *J.H.S.* 1901, vol. xxi. part. 1.

⁶⁵ Daremberg-Saglio, *s.v.* Gryphon.

⁶⁶ Pindar, *Olymp.* iii. 17.

of the griffins and Arimaspians has ever since possessed a strange fascination; beside Aeschylus' lines (Prom. 803 *et seq.*):—

ὄξυστόμους γὰρ Ζηνὸς ἀκραγεῖς κύνας
Γρύπας φύλαξαι, τὸν τε μουνῶπα στρατὸν
Ἀριμασπὸν ἱπποβάμον', οἱ χρυσόρρυτον
οἰκοῦσιν ἀμφὶ νᾶμα Πλούτωνος πόρον·

set Milton (*Par. Lost*, ii. 948):—

'As when a gryphon through the wilderness
With winged course o'er hill or moory dale
Pursues the Arimaspians, who *by stealth*⁶⁷
Has from his wakeful custody purloined
The guarded gold.'

The monuments representing these legends of griffins and Arimaspians are not earlier than the fifth century B.C., but, as already seen, griffins had been familiar as a motive in art for many centuries, borrowed from the East. From Attic tetradrachms we know that the temple statue of Apollo at Delphi had a griffin on each side.⁶⁸

Ctesias, who identifies the Griffins with the gold-digging ants of India, mentioned by Herod. iii. 102, gives the most exact description of them,—*γρύπες, ὄρνεα τετράποδα, μέγεθος ὅσον λύκος, σκέλη καὶ ὄνυχες οἰάπερ λέων, τὰ ἐν τῷ ἄλλῳ σώματι πτερὰ μέλανα, ἐρυθρὰ δὲ τὰ ἐν τῷ στήθει*,⁶⁹ and Pausanias⁷⁰ contributes a further touch,—*ἥδη δὲ καὶ ἄλλα ἤκουσα, τοῖς γρυφὶ στίγματα ὅποια καὶ τοῖς παρδάλεσιν εἶναι*.

Sphinxes are found as companions of the griffins from the time of the Mycenaean signets, and they too are undoubtedly of Eastern origin. They were associated with the worship of Dionysus as well as with that of Apollo, and it may have been as creatures of the Bacchic cycle that they appeared round the palace of Seyles at Olbia, as Herodotus tells of his initiation in the Bacchic mysteries, which finally led to his death.

It is hardly possible here to make more than a bare reference to the close connection of Apollo and the Hyperboreans which seems to go back far beyond any period for which we can have anything like historical evidence. It cannot be wholly omitted, however, if there is any basis for the conjecture already made,—that the permanence of the cult of Apollo at Olbia was in part due to a feeling that the god of the north was the fitting deity for the most northerly Greek state,—a feeling which artists did their best to perpetuate; note especially the constant occurrence of the griffin in works of art found in this neighbourhood. There is no doubt that in very early times the Greeks knew something of lands to the far north,—the earliest reference in literature is of course Odys. x. 84–86.

ἐνθα κ' αὔπνος ἀνὴρ δοιοὺς ἐξήρατο μισθοῦς,
τὸν μὲν βουκολέων, τὸν δ' ἄργυφα μῆλα νομέων·
ἐγγὺς γὰρ νυκτός τε καὶ ἡματος εἰσι κέλευθοι.

⁶⁷ *ὄρεα*. Herod. iii. 116.

⁶⁸ Furtwängler, *Arch. Zeit.* 1882, p. 332.

⁶⁹ Ctesias, *Indica*, 12, ed. Bähr.

⁷⁰ viii. 2, 7.

Herodotus' account of the offerings sent by the Hyperboreans to Delos⁷¹ is of the highest interest in this connection, as Delos was from very early times the centre of the Ionian worship of Apollo, and we have here a proof of very ancient intercourse between the North and the Aegean. The route as described by Herodotus should be carefully noticed. Prof. Ridgeway⁷² says: "The only avenue between Greece and upper Europe in early days was that which starting at Dodona led up through Epirus to the head of the Adriatic." So the Black Sea would appear to have been unknown to the Greeks until the period when Miletus began colonising on its shores. May we see in this connection of the "arterial highway," as Professor Ridgeway calls it, with the service of Apollo the origin, or at any rate an early and striking instance, of his function as god of journeys and streets? Notice here also the existence of the city Apollonia on the Adriatic, not far from Dodona, and perhaps a station on the route of the Hyperboreans. Olen was the earliest poet to deal with the subject of the Hyperboreans, as we know from both Herodotus and Pausanias.⁷³ Herodotus says,—*οὗτος δὲ ὁ Ὀλὴν καὶ τοὺς ἄλλους τοὺς παλαιούς ὕμνους ἐποίησε ἐκ Λυκίης ἐλθὼν τοὺς ἀειδομένους ἐν Δήλῳ*. Here again we have Lycia, another of the early localities connected with the cult of Apollo, brought into close intercourse with Delos and the North. Pausanias⁷⁴ says, quoting a hymn;—*Ὀλὴν θ' ὅς γένητο πρῶτος Φοῖβοιο προφάτας*. We may compare him with Aristaeus, who seems also to have combined the characters of poet, traveller, and priest of Apollo, and observe again the connection of *travel* with the cult of Apollo—Apollo *'Αρχηγέτης*⁷⁵—a feature prominent later in the work of the Delphic oracle in forwarding colonisation.

Alcaeus⁷⁶ speaks of swans bringing the new-born Apollo to the land of the Hyperboreans. Swans were among the creatures attached to the worship of Apollo.⁷⁷ Pindar's reference to the Hyperboreans as the "henchmen of Apollo" has already been quoted, but there is also a reference to the periodical sojourning of the god in the North in *Pyth.* iv. 5.

οὐκ ἀποδάμου Ἀπόλλωνος τυχόντος.

Later poets need not be quoted; all that is aimed at here is to indicate the likelihood of the cult of Apollo at Olbia growing stronger as the centuries went by, and his ancient connection with the surrounding lands was made constantly more evident alike by literature and art.

⁷¹ iv. 33–35.

⁷² *Early Age of Greece*, i. p. 368.

⁷³ viii. 21, 3.

⁷⁴ x. 5, 7.

⁷⁵ See references in Pauly-Wissowa, *sub v.*

ii.¹ p. 44, to cults of Apollo under this title.

⁷⁶ Quoted by Himerius. See Bergk, *P.L.G.* iii. p. 146.

⁷⁷ Compare Cic., *Tusc.* i., 30, 73, (quoting from Plato, *Phaedo*, 85 B.) 'Itaque commemorat ut cygni, qui non sine causa Apollini dicantur, sed quod ab eo divinationem habere videantur, qua providentes quid in morte boni sit cum cantu et voluptate moriantur, sic omnibus bonis et doctis esse faciendum.' Also see Preller-Robert, *Gr. Myth.* i.¹ p. 243.

Demeter.

Demeter must be placed next in order to Apollo, as she has some claim to be regarded as the special city-goddess. Her head is a frequent type upon the coins, and it seems necessary to identify the Tyche type of this city with Demeter, on account of the ears of barley on the walled crown. For the apparent existence at Olbia of Apollo and Demeter side by side as civic deities, we might compare the position of Athene and Poseidon-Erechtheus at Athens. That Apollo and Demeter did have some such association at Olbia is made probable by the fact that their heads appear upon coins which have similar reverse types. But Apollo would seem to have held the more important position of the two, as his title of *Προστάτης* would go far to show; it is also significant that while there are many Olbian inscriptions referring to Apollo, not one has yet been found bearing the name of Demeter, and there are only three in the whole North Euxine district, all from Panticapaeum.⁷⁸ Of course, in a place where the remains are as fragmentary as is the case at Olbia, the absence of inscriptions cannot be regarded as conclusive, but still it seems curious that none has been found, if Demeter held a place of such importance. Against the absence of the inscriptions may be set the fact of the constant appearance of Demeter in the vase-paintings that come from this district; it is perhaps not too much to say that Demeter-myths have furnished more subjects for the artists than any others.⁷⁹ Also Herodotus⁸⁰ speaks of the existence of a temple of Demeter opposite Olbia; which would be conclusive evidence if there were not a variant reading of *Μητρός* for *Δήμητρος*; as it is, the passage can only be quoted as a possible support to the view of the importance of Demeter's cult at Olbia at this early period. In any case, there would undoubtedly have been a temple to Demeter there, whether she held the position of chief goddess of the city or not, as her worship was general among all Ionian states.⁸¹ For the significance of the worship of Demeter 'als althellenische Göttin und als Göttin der Civilization,' Preller-Robert may be quoted⁸²:— 'Die hohe Bedeutung der Demeter für das attische Staatsleben [zeigt sich] deutlich darin, dass sie mit Zeus und Apollon zusammen Schwurgöttin ist, sowohl bei politischen Verträgen als im Eid der Beamten und Richter.'⁸³ This is worth noting here, in view of the apparent association of Apollo and Demeter at Olbia as civic deities.

The Olbian coins bearing heads of Demeter give rise to questions of considerable difficulty. Head,⁸⁴ under Olbia, says that the principal type on

⁷⁸ Two of these (Lat. ii. 7, 20), are of the fourth century B.C.; the other (Lat. ii. 13), to Demeter *Θεσμοφόρος*, of the third century B.C.

⁷⁹ For some beautiful representations of these vases, see the *Compte-Rendu*, passim.

⁸⁰ iv. 53.

⁸¹ Cp. Preller-Robert. *Gr. Myth.* i. 2 p. 754.

For other references to worship of Demeter in

Ionian cities, see Herod., vi. 16 (Ephesus); ix. 97 (Miletus); Strabo, xiv. 633; Dittenberger, *Sylloge* 655; *I.G.A.* 501; Diog. Laert., ix. 43; Athen. ii. p. 46, F.

⁸² *Gr. Myth.* i. 2 p. 781.

⁸³ See *C.I.A.* i. 9, 13, ii. 49, b. 578.

⁸⁴ *Hist. Num.* p. 233.

the gold and silver money is the head of Demeter. This seems somewhat misleading. The Berlin catalogue only gives one gold coin of Olbia⁸⁵ (excluding the late coin of Pharzoius, No. 146); this has a head of Demeter. Out of the seven silver coins described (31-37), only two have heads of Demeter (including No. 37 with the head of Demeter-Tyche). The British Museum catalogue only describes one silver coin (No. 1), and it has Demeter as type. Von Sallet, in describing No. 31 of the Berlin catalogue, says that No. 1 in the British Museum (see fig. 4 below) is an example of the same coin in bad silver, and that a very good example is that given in *Zeitsch. f. Num.* X. Taf. iii. The head on this latter coin is very much more beautiful than that in the British Museum example. De Koehne, who describes about 160 Olbian coins, only gives nine which bear heads of Demeter, three of which are silver and six copper.⁸⁶ Pick, in his first volume, which has already been so often quoted, gives five plates of Olbian coins, in which presumably examples of every known type are given, but unluckily the letterpress describing the plates has not yet been published, so that the number of existing examples of each coin is not indicated, nor have we the editor's aid in vexed questions of identification. One hundred and eight coins are represented in Pick's plates, of which about seventeen can be quite certainly assigned to Demeter, excluding those of which the identification is more or less doubtful. Two of these coins are gold (the only gold ones in the collection, leaving out three very late ones) and four silver; the rest are all copper. So the statement of Head, which could be made more emphatic with regard to the gold coins, on which Demeter seems to be the only type in the earlier period, appears to require modification with regard to the silver ones, as well as the addition that the head of Demeter is frequently found on copper coins.

Before considering the various types of Demeter which appear upon the coins, it will be best to attempt to determine the significance of the wheat-ear which appears as a reverse type on many, and the grain of wheat which is seen on others: (the wheat-ear also occurs as a counter mark). But these emblems frequently occur with a fish-type (to give it this general though unscientific name), and the discussion of the two cannot be kept apart. If the fish-type represents a sturgeon or a sterlet, so very common in the rivers of South Russia, it may fairly be considered a commercial emblem, and the wheat-ear can fall into the same category; if on the other hand it represents a dolphin, the commercial significance is scarcely possible. Lenormant⁸⁷ regards it as a sterlet, 'type de la mouette saisissant le poisson sterlet,' and says that it is imitated from the coins of Sinope; it is certainly impossible to look at the coins in question, dating from 415 B.C.,⁸⁸ without being struck with the close resemblance to the type on the Olbian coins. They are probably earlier than the Olbian coins, the type of which may therefore have been borrowed from them; we shall notice below under Helios another possible instance of an Olbian coin with a type borrowed from Sinope.

⁸⁵ No. 30, Taf. ii. 18. Similar to Pick's example, Pl. ix. 18, though not the same coin.

⁸⁶ Musée du Prince Kotschoubey, i. p. 64, 65.

⁸⁷ *La Monnaie dans l'Antiquité*, i. p. 158.

⁸⁸ B. M. Cat. Pontus, P. 95 et seq., Pl. xxi.

xxii.

In the British Museum catalogue both these types are described as dolphins. Some of the types on Olbian coins undoubtedly are dolphins, e.g. the reverse type of Pick's example, Pl. ix. 24, which has probably a head of Poseidon on the obverse; but there are other coins, notably Pick, Pl. ix. 3, where the long snout, the position of the eye, and the straightness of the fish seem to indicate a sterlet rather than a dolphin. Where the fish is curved, it would seem safer to identify it as a dolphin, especially as the dorsal fin near the head, which is a characteristic of the dolphin but not of the sturgeon, seems to be clearly shown on most of the Olbian coins of this type.⁸⁹ Perhaps it is impossible now to decide which type the Olbian die-cutters intended to represent. Would it be hazardous to conjecture that the general pattern of the type—the sea-eagle upon the fish—was borrowed from Sinope, and that the idea of the original wavered between the emblematic dolphin and the purely commercial sturgeon? There undoubtedly is a good deal of difference in type between these fish-like creatures, which this hypothesis seems to explain. When we find an ear or grain of corn and a fish-type on the same coin, and further remember that grain and dried fish were two of the main exports of Olbia, it is difficult not to think that the commercial explanation is the true one.⁹⁰ The dolphin is not the most obvious emblem of Apollo, and it does not seem at all certain that it would have been chosen to accompany the wheat-ear if it had been intended to symbolise Apollo and Demeter together as civic deities.⁹¹ The obverse type of these coins is sometimes Apollo, sometimes Demeter.

To come to the coins themselves. The first coin (after the copper ones in Plate VIII.) given by Pick (Pl. IX. 1, gold) does not show the wheat-ears in the hair of the goddess very clearly, but this is only because the coin is struck unevenly, and little room is left on the top of the head for them to appear. The reverse shows the eagle and fish-type, and above the eagle is a wheat-ear. The heads on No. 2 (silver)⁹² and No. 3 (copper) more distinctly indicate Demeter, as in each case the two wheat-ears in the hair, above the forehead, are clearly shown. Both these coins, and also 4, 5, 6 (which have Demeter on the obverse), have the eagle on the fish, in varying attitudes, as reverse type. Of these coins von Sallet in the Berlin catalogue, under No.

⁸⁹ If the dorsal fin is really the decisive feature, perhaps it may help to decide the question of the fish-shaped coins of Olbia in favour of Mr. G. F. Hill's alternative explanation—that they are degenerate representations of pigs of bronze, as a pig of metal was sometimes called *ὀλφίς* (cp. French *saumon*), (*Handbook of Gr. and Rom. Coins*, p. 3). The most marked characteristic of these fish-shaped pieces is the dorsal fin just behind the head.

⁹⁰ Note that Von Sallet describes the head of a fish, which appears with a grain of corn as the reverse type of No. 83 in the Berlin catalogue, as a sturgeon's. Apollo's head is on the obverse of this coin, which is the same as Pick,

Pl. ix. 14, and is of very good style.

⁹¹ The tunnies on the altar from Cyzicus described by Mr. Hasluck (*J.H.S.* xxii. (1902), p. 128), were recognized as such by peasants on the spot; it would be interesting to know if a South Russian peasant would identify the Olbian coin-type as a sturgeon. The fish on Pick's Pl. ix. 3, also ix. 22, is not at all like the typical dolphin that appears, e.g. on coins of Tarentum. (See Gardner's *Types of Greek Coins*, Pl. i. 22, etc.)

⁹² Similar to No. 1 in the Brit. Mus. Cat., given in fig. 4, where the fish seems to resemble the sturgeon rather than the dolphin.

38, says: 'The heads on the pieces with this reverse type are sometimes certainly Demeter with light wreath, sometimes Apollo, laureate (perhaps). Distinction is difficult on account of careless workmanship.' The heads on 7 and 8 are more doubtful. The next that is clearly Demeter is 15. This has a fish-type on the reverse, as have also 17, 18, 19. Both the wheat-ear and the fish-type appear on 16. The head on 30 is very similar to some of



FIG. 4.—SILVER COIN OF OLBIA IN THE BRITISH MUSEUM.

those which are clearly Demeter, but in this case the reverse type is a bow in case and an axe. In Plate X. we have more of the coins with the eagle and fish as reverse type, of which 12 and 13 appear to be probably Demeter. The other coins are of more doubtful attribution.

Next comes the series of coins with the turreted female head on the obverse, and the kneeling archer on the reverse.⁹³ The wheat-ears in the coin given in fig. 5 seem to make the identification as Demeter-Tyche



FIG. 5.—BRONZE COIN OF OLBIA IN THE BERLIN MUSEUM.

certain, though there is apparently no other example of the walled crown on the head of Demeter. It belongs, of course, commonly to Cybele, and frequently to Aphrodite⁹⁴ and Anaitis.⁹⁵ Artemis has it on the late imperial coins of Gerasa in the Syrian Decapolis,⁹⁶ and at Chersonesus.⁹⁷ The British Museum has an example of these Olbian coins (No. 17), which is described as 'Head of the City, left, wearing a mural crown and necklace.' The heads of the Tyche of the City, or City-goddess, are of course too common on coins to need illustration, but the identification with Demeter seems to be

⁹³ Pick, Pl. x. 1-4. Pl. x. 1 is No. 119 in the Berlin catalogue, and is given in the accompanying figure 5. Is the choice of the archer as reverse type significant of local feeling, like the bow and battle-axe on the Borysthenes series?

⁹⁴ Especially in Cyprus, see Farnell, *Gk. Cults*, ii. p. 704.

⁹⁵ E.g. on coins of Amastris in Paphlagonia,

early third century B.C. See B. M. Cat. (Pontus).

⁹⁶ Farnell, *Gk. Cults*, ii. p. 585.

⁹⁷ Von Sallet says under coin No. 4 (Berlin Cat.) Taf. i. 6. 'Artemis, as City-Goddess, seems here to resemble Tyche, as very probably Demeter on the copper coins of Olbia (with the archer as reverse).'

unique. It may be noted that the coin given by Pick (Plate XI. 1) with the turreted female head on the obverse, has the reverse type of the eagle (on the fish ?) very similar to the type on the coins which undoubtedly have Demeter on the obverse.⁹⁸ The last Olbian coin in Pick's examples, a silver piece of King Inismeus, has also a Tyche head as the reverse type.

The number and variety of these coins seem to make clear Demeter's importance at Olbia—second only to Apollo; a position easily understood considering that the staple trade of Olbia was the exportation of grain.

Cybele.

The cult of Cybele may be taken next, not because we have evidence to prove that it was of special importance at Olbia, but because it has already been referred to twice under Demeter.

We have only one inscription referring to this cult at Olbia, given by Latyshev,⁹⁹ and it is of Roman date:—

[ἡ δαίνα . . .]ωντος τοῦ Διονυσίου
[θυγά]τηρ, Σωκρατίδου γυνή.
[Σωκ]ρατίδης Φιλίνου τὴν ἑαυτοῦ γυναῖκα
Μητρί θεῶν ἱερῆσαμένην.

There is, however, an inscription from Panticapaeum of the third century B.C.,¹⁰⁰ which may be quoted here as evidence, if any is needed, that the cult of the Great Mother existed in this district in the earlier period:—

Βασιλεύοντος Παιρισάδου τοῦ Σπαρτόκου Ἑστίαία Μηνοδώρου θυγάτηρ
ἱερωμένη ἀνέθηκεν Μητρί Φρυγίαί.

The reading of *Μητρός* for *Δήμητρος* in Herod. iv. 53. has been already spoken of under Demeter; and, if accepted, would of course give very much higher antiquity for the cult. None of the Olbian inscriptions containing the name of a deity go back anything like so far as the date of Herodotus' visit to Olbia, so that he is our most ancient authority for anything concerning the cults of the city.

Pick¹⁰¹ gives one coin which bears a head of Cybele; a reproduction is given in fig. 6. It is apparently rare, as there is no example in the Berlin collection, and De Koehne¹⁰² only quotes one, which seems to be the same as that given by Pick:—

⁹⁸ The two kinds of mural crowns should of course be carefully distinguished, that belonging to the Tyche type, and the much heavier one with the veil, worn by Cybele. A reference to the accompanying figures will make this clear. See also De Koehne on this point (*loc. cit.* p. 68). He sets the date of these Olbian coins

at 250–200 B.C., just at the time when the personification of the Tyche of the City was becoming common throughout the Greek world.

⁹⁹ i. 107.

¹⁰⁰ ii. 17.

¹⁰¹ Pl. x. No. 35.

¹⁰² *loc. cit.* p. 66.

<i>Obverse.</i> Tête couverte d'un voile, tombant en arrière et d'une couronne murale, derrière un rameau en contremarque.	<i>Reverse.</i> ΟΛΒΙΟ— ΠΤΟΛΙ Tympanon. Æ. 2½.
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FIG. 6.—BRONZE COIN OF OLBIA (FROM PICK).

Cybele, is, however, a frequent type on the coins of the North Euxine district of Imperial date. Several examples are given by Pick (Plate XVIII.) where full figures of the goddess occur; note especially No. 14, a coin of Istros, where the lions beneath her throne are very distinct. De Koehne¹⁰³ mentions the finding of a colossal seated statue of Cybele at Panticapaeum, which so exactly corresponds to the type on the coin that it would seem almost certain that the latter is a copy of the statue. The Athenian statue of the Mother of the Gods by Pheidias¹⁰⁴ seems not to have worn the mural crown. Arrian¹⁰⁵ does not mention it among the other attributes, and the numerous Attic votive reliefs, which must have had this statue as their type, do not show it.¹⁰⁶ The cult of Cybele in its various aspects approached so closely to that of other female deities that a distinction is often difficult. She was looked upon as the foundress of states and cities, whose walls she wears as a crown like the Syrian Astarte, hence her name 'mater turrita' or 'turrigera.'¹⁰⁷

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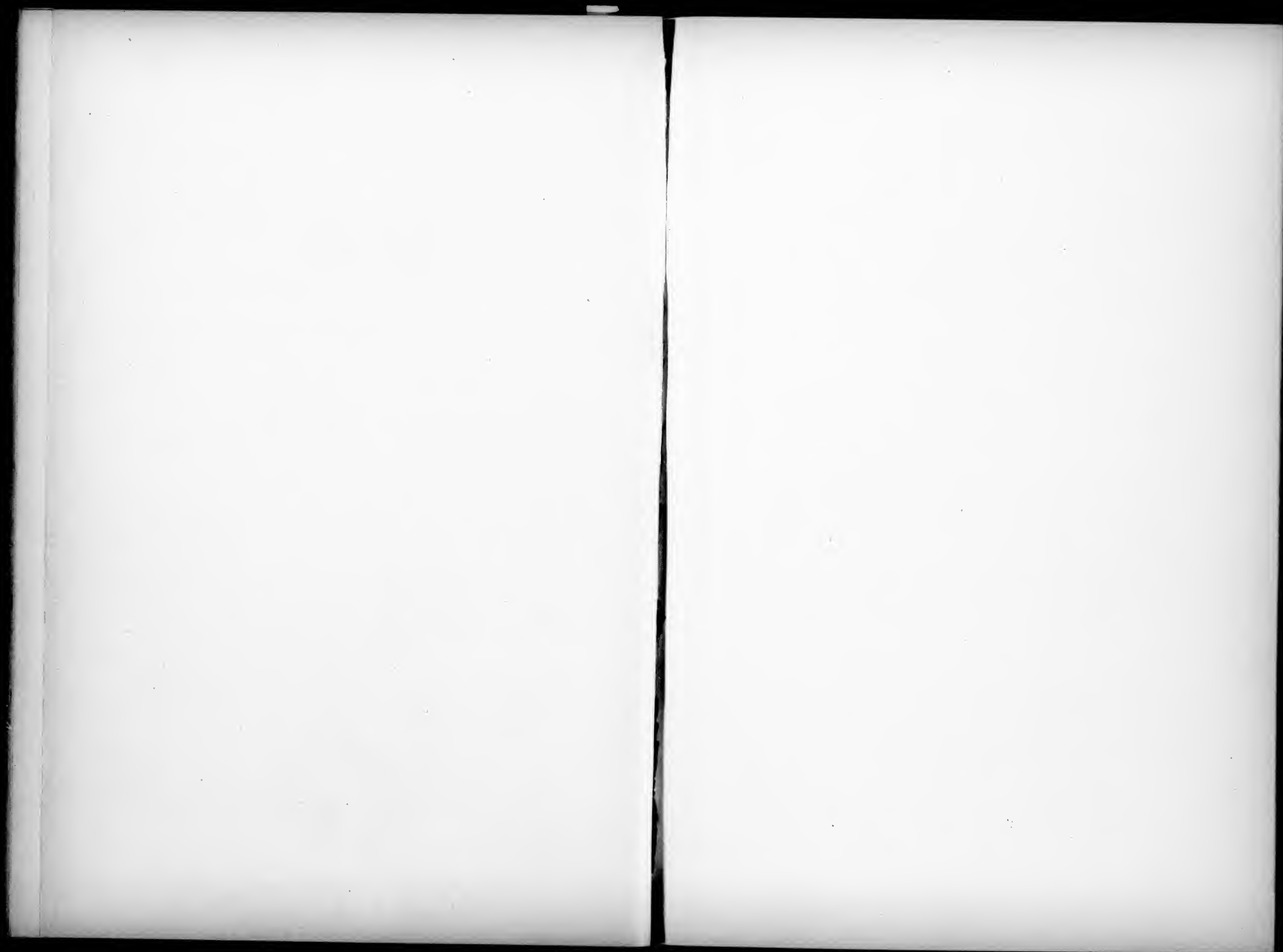
¹⁰³ *loc. cit.* p. 67.

¹⁰⁴ By Pheidias according to Paus. i. 3, 5. and Arrian; according to Pliny (*N.H.* 36, 17), by Agoracritus. It represented the goddess with a cymbal in her hand, and lions under her chair.

¹⁰⁵ *Peripl.*, p. 9.

¹⁰⁶ Stephani, *Herakl.*, p. 67.

¹⁰⁷ Verg. *Aen.* vii. 785, Ovid, *Fast.* iv. 219. See O. Jahn, *Arch. Zeit.* 1864, 174, A. 3, who says the tower-crown probably came from Asia to Greece (Böttiger, *Kunst. Myth.* i. p. 286); when it became prevalent is not known. See also Mr. A. J. Evans, *Myc. Tree and Pillar Cult*, *J.H.S.* vol. xxi. (1901), p. 166.



THE CULTS OF OLBIA.

PART II.

(Continued from Vol. XXII, p. 267).

Aphrodite.

NEITHER literature nor coins bear any witness to the cult of Aphrodite at Olbia, but we have an inscription¹ which is of the highest interest.

[Ἀφρο]δίτη Εὐπλοίαι
[Ποσ]ίδεος Ποσιδείου
χαριστήριον.

This inscription is of the first century after Christ; Posideos the son of Posideos is no doubt the same individual who dedicated offerings at Neapolis² to Zeus Atabyrios, Athene Lindia, and Ἀχιλλεὶ νήσου [μεδέοντι]. Boeckh³ conjectures him to have been a Rhodian, no doubt because of the dedications to Athene Lindia and Zeus Atabyrios, and also because Aphrodite Euploia was worshipped at Cnidus.

This inscription is most important, because the epithet Εὐπλοία is so very rare. Pausanias⁴ in describing the temple to Aphrodite built by Conon in the Peiraeus, near the sea, in honour of his naval victory off Cnidus, says there were three temples of Aphrodite at Cnidus: νεώτατον δὲ ἦν Κνιδίαν οἱ πολλοί, Κνίδιοι δὲ αὐτοὶ καλοῦσιν Εὐπλοίαν.⁵ Pausanias does not say that Conon's temple at the Peiraeus was dedicated to Aphrodite Εὐπλοία, but an inscription discovered in the Peiraeus makes this probable. (We have no epigraphic authority for the title Εὐπλοία as early as the time of Conon). The inscription⁶ reads—

Ἀργεῖος Ἀργείου Τρικο[ρύσιος]
στρατηγίας ἐπὶ τὸν Πειρα[ιᾶ]
Ἀφροδίτῃ Εὐπλοίαι τ[ύχη] ἀγαθῇ ?
ἀνέθηκεν.

¹ Latyshev, i. 94.
² Latyshev, i. 242, 243, 244.
³ C.I.G. ii. 2103 b.
⁴ i. 1, 3.

⁵ Note that Farnell (*Gk. Cults*, ii. p. 689) supports the view that the Cnidian statue by Praxiteles represented Aphrodite Εὐπλοία.
⁶ C.I.A. ii. 1206.

THE CULTS OF OLBIA.

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The Argeus here mentioned was archon 97—96 B.C.⁷ Besides this inscription and the one at Olbia, there are only two others where this title of Aphrodite occurs. One,⁸ from Aegeae in Cilicia, 1st century B.C., is a dedication to Aphrodite Εὐπλοία together with Poseidon Ἀσφάλειος. The other is from Mylasa,⁹ probably of later date; it refers to ἱερεὺς Ἀφροδίτης Εὐπλοίας. Many cognate titles, however, are known from inscriptions, e.g. at Troezen an inscription¹⁰ of the 3rd century B.C. speaks of τᾶς Ἀφροδίτας τᾶς ἐμ βάσσαις, and at Panticapaeum, in an inscription of the Roman period,¹¹ we find Aphrodite Ναυαρχίς and Poseidon Σωσίνοος side by side.¹²

The word ΕΥΠΛΟΙ is found on a gem which represents Eros riding on a dolphin.¹³ Compare with this the inscription on a lamp shaped like a boat¹⁴ with the words, Εὐπλοία λαβέ με τὸν Ἥλιοσέραπιν.¹⁵ Welcker¹⁶ quotes with approval Schneidewin's emendation of Archilochus¹⁷

πολλὰ δ' εὐπλοκάμου Εὐπλοίης ἄλδς ἐν πελάγεσσιν
θεσσάμενοι ἡλυκερὸν νόστον.

A more detailed consideration of Aphrodite under this aspect would be out of place here: see Farnell, vol. ii, p. 636—7; 689 et seq.

Aphrodite Ἀπάτουρος.

As the inscription to Aphrodite Εὐπλοία is of late period, reference must be made to inscriptions from other places on the North Euxine which refer to the worship of Aphrodite.

The oldest inscription of Sarmatia,¹⁸ dating from the early part of the 5th century B.C., is a dedication to

ΘΕ:-ΑΓΑΤΟΡΟ

i.e. Aphrodite Ἀπάτουρος. This was found near the river Kuban. At Phanagoria a late inscription¹⁹ refers to Aphrodite Ἀπατουριάς; and there are two that refer to this cult at Panticapaeum; one, perhaps 1st century B.C.,²⁰ contains the words

⁷ Notice Farnell's curious error (*Greek Cults*, ii. p. 733) in dating this inscription in the latter part of the fourth century B.C.

⁸ C.I.G. 4443.

⁹ Μουσ. καὶ Βιβλιοθ. Σμύρνης, 1875, p. 50; B.C.H. v. 1880, 108; xii. 1888, 30.

¹⁰ Collitz, *Dial.-Inscr.* 3364 b, l. 14.

¹¹ Latyshev, ii. 25.

¹² For this connection with Poseidon compare Paus. vii. 24, 2, πρὸς θαλάσσης Ἀφροδίτης ἱερὸν ἐν Αἰγίῳ καὶ μετ' αὐτὸ Ποσειδῶνος, and also *Compte Rendu* 1881, 134-5; 1877, 246 et seq. with the Atlas, Plate v. No. 1, where Aphrodite appears with a dolphin on a vase. C.I.G. 7390, gives the inscription on a black figured vase in which Poseidon appears with a female

-in a chariot, Ἀφροδίτης. Ποσειδῶνος. Πυθοκλῆς καλός.

¹³ C.I.G. 7309, on which Boeckh comments, 'pertinuit ad navigationem in pelago amoris.'

¹⁴ C.I.G. 8514.

¹⁵ Is it worth while to note, in view of the supposition that Posideos was a Rhodian, that the head of the sun appears on this lamp? 'in extrema navicula caput radiatum Solis, quale esse solet in nummis Rhodiorum' (Boeckh).

¹⁶ *Gr. Götterlehre*, ii, p. 706.

¹⁷ *Zeitschr. f. d. Alterth.* 1845, S. 166.

¹⁸ C.I.G. ii. 2133, Lat. ii. 469.

¹⁹ Lat. ii. 352.

²⁰ Lat. ii. 19.

ἀνέθηκε[αν τὴν στῆ]-
λη[ν] Ἀφροδίτ[ε]ι τῇ Οὐρανίᾳ Ἀπατού-
[ρ]ου μεδεούση.

This Ἀπάτουρον is referred to by Strabo xi. 495, ἔστι δὲ καὶ ἐν τῇ Φαναγορίᾳ τῆς Ἀφροδίτης ἱερὸν ἐπίσημον τῆς Ἀπατούρου. The other Panticapaeum inscription²¹ is of the Roman period, and gives similar titles. One from Phanagoria²² of the 4th century B.C. ought perhaps, to be quoted:—

Δήμαρχος Σκύθεω
ἀνέθηκεν Ἀφροδίτ[ε]ι
Οὐρανίῃ Ἀπατούρο(ν)
μεδεούση
ἄρχοντος
Λεύκανος Βοσπόρ[ο](ν)
καὶ Θεοδοσίης.

For this aspect of Aphrodite see Preller-Robert,²³ who say, apparently relying on this inscription, that at Phanagoria Aphrodite Apatouros does not seem to have differed from Aphrodite Urania, and remark on the prevalence of the worship of Aphrodite on the Black Sea, in her aspect as goddess of the clan²⁴; in which connection it is worth noting that a great number of representations of Aphrodite, chiefly in terracotta, have been found in the Tauric Chersonese, one of which, at any rate, will have to be referred to later. Farnell²⁵ regards this refined cult of the goddess as the patroness of the married life of the clan as a native Greek development. May we press this as additional evidence of the purely Greek character of the colonies on the North Euxine? It may be noted that there was a month in the Ionic calendar called Ἀπατουρέων.²⁶

As to the monumental evidence for this cult, Farnell seems right in saying (p. 705) that we have no sure monumental representation of Aphrodite as the goddess of the clan, or the civic community, unless we accept as genuine the relief upon which appears the inscription Θεο Ἀπατούρο already quoted. This relief represents 'Aphrodite with Eros and Ares; its style is quite out of keeping with the date of the inscription. . . . The sculptor knew no other way of designating her as the clan-goddess, except by adding the figure of Ares for the idea of marriage and of Eros for the idea of love; and without the inscription, no one would recognize in her the goddess Ἀπατούρη.' Stephani, on the other hand,²⁷ regards a relief in terracotta as a representation of Aphrodite Ἀπάτουρος, but apparently this comes about because he considers Ἀπάτουρος and Πάνδημος as interchangeable

²¹ Lat. ii. 28.

²² Lat. ii. 349, C.I.G. 2120. Another, Lat. iv. 419 (fourth century B.C.).

²³ *Gr. Myth.* i. p. 378.

²⁴ The word Ἀπάτουρος is of course derived from the Ionic festival of the Apatouria.

²⁵ *Gk. Cults*, ii, p. 656 *et seq.*

²⁶ See references in Pauly-Wissowa, under *Apatourion*. I. p. 2680. One of the Olbian months had this title, Lat. i. 28.

²⁷ *Compte Rendu*, 1859, p. 126. Atlas, plate iv. No. 1, Farnell *Gk. Cults*, ii. p. 686, note.

terms. He describes the relief as representing the goddess wrapped in a chiton, himation, and veil, seated on a goat, running rapidly to the right of the spectator. Two kids gambol below, indicating Aphrodite as the goddess of the generative power. That the goddess is Aphrodite is proved by the presence of Eros behind her, and a dove flying in front. The goddess, he says, is represented in her character of Apatouros or Pandemos. Elsewhere²⁸ he refers to a vase representing Aphrodite on a he-goat as a representation of Aphrodite Ἀπάτουρος, and compares the well-known statue by Scopas; but as I should regard Apatouros and Pandemos as separate titles, consideration of these types of Aphrodite would here be out of place.

It is perhaps worth noting that the name Apatourios occurs frequently as a proper name in inscriptions from the North Euxine district, among others in an Olbian one of the fifth century B.C., one of the only two known of so early a date.²⁹

Aphrodite Οὐρανία.

One other title of Aphrodite must be mentioned,—that of Οὐρανία, as it occurs in two inscriptions of Phanagoria³⁰ of the fourth century B.C. and two later ones of Panticapaeum.³¹ It may be noted, however, that in all but one of these inscriptions (ii. 347) the title is joined with that of Ἀπάτουρος. Here Herodotus may be quoted, who says (iv. 59) that Aphrodite Οὐρανία was one of the special deities worshipped by the Scythians, and that they called her Artimpasa; though, if we are right in believing that Olbia in its earlier period was little affected by Scythian customs, either in religion or anything else, the reference has little point here. Farnell³² says: 'The clearest sign of the Eastern goddess in the Greek community is the title Οὐρανία,' and notes that the worship of the goddess in this aspect is especially found in places which had connection with Asia, instancing Panticapaeum as a Milesian colony. It may be worth while here to remark that De Koehne³³ traces the origin of the cult of Helios at Olbia to its connection with Sinope; and the cult of Aphrodite Οὐρανία may have been introduced in a similar way.

In summing up the evidence for the cult of Aphrodite at Olbia, it must be admitted at once that we have no direct testimony except the one late inscription to Aphrodite Εὐπλοία. Still, it is reasonable to suppose that the cult was of some importance at Olbia, as we know that the worship of Aphrodite Ἀπάτουρος was prevalent in the North Euxine district; moreover, the number of representations of Aphrodite found there, especially in the Tauric Chersonese, helps to confirm this belief.

²⁸ *Compte Rendu*, 1871, plate v. N^o. 3, and p. 138, 184.

²⁹ Lat. iv. 28 a.

³⁰ Lat. ii. 343, 347, iv. 419.

³¹ Lat. ii. 19, 28.

³² *Gk. Cults*, ii. p. 629.

³³ *Mus. du P. K.* i. 59.

Artemis.

The evidence for the cult of Artemis at Olbia is of an exactly opposite kind to that for Aphrodite; in the case of Artemis we have testimony from coins, but none from inscriptions. The type is not a very common one on Olbian coins. There is an example in the British Museum (No. 16) which has a head of Artemis on the obverse, and a quiver with strap on the reverse. This seems to be similar to the coin given by Pick.³⁴ Three are given in the Berlin catalogue, Nos. 128-130, not unlike the above. De Koehne³⁵ gives six, but four of these have been sometimes recognized as Demeter; the reverse is a dolphin or a sea-eagle, or both, and there seems to be no special reason for supposing that the head on the obverse is that of Artemis.

Before considering at all the mass of literary material relating to the cult of Artemis on the North Euxine, the inscriptions referring to it had better be mentioned. There is one from Phanagoria of the fourth century B.C.³⁶ which begins

Ξενοκλείδης Πόσιος ἀνέθηκε τὸν ναὸν
Ἀρτέμιδι Ἀγροτέραι.

With this may be compared the silver coin of Phanagoria, of the first century B.C., which has on the obverse a head of Artemis Agrotera.³⁷ At Panticapaeum we find an inscription of the fourth century B.C. to Artemis Ἐφεσείη, which is interesting as again showing the connection of Panticapaeum with Asia,³⁸ and at Tanais there is one of Roman period, beginning θεῇ Ἀρτέμιδι μεδεούσῃ.³⁹

More interesting, perhaps, are the two inscriptions from Chersonesus,⁴⁰ at which place, as we have already seen, Artemis held the position of city-goddess, and appears on the coins wearing the mural crown.⁴¹ The first inscription, which is of third or second century B.C., is fragmentary, but contains the words τᾶς Παρθένου, and the second, which is a very long decree, has at l. 24 the words ἀ διὰ παντὸς Χερσονησιτῶν προστατούσα Παρθένος, which have already been quoted in comparison with the title Apollo Προστάτης. Further down we have a reference to the Παρθενεία held in honour of Artemis, l. 48:

δεδόχθαι τῇ βουλῇ καὶ τῷ δάμῳ στεφαν-
ῶσαι Διόφαντον Ἀσκληπιοδώρου χρυσέῳ
στεφάνῳ Παρθενείῳ ἐν τῇ πομπῇ,

³⁴ *Die Antiken Münzen Nord-Griechenlands*, i. 1. Plate X. No. 6.

³⁵ *loc. cit.* pp. 62, 63.

³⁶ *Lat. ii.* 344.

³⁷ *Brit. Mus. Cat. Pontus*, p. 3, Pl. I. 6.

³⁸ *Lat. ii.* 11, Dittenberger, *Syll.*³ No. 326, see also, Paus. 4. 31. 8. Ἐφεσίαν δὲ Ἀρτέμιν

πόλεις τε νομίζουσιν αἱ πᾶσαι καὶ ἄνδρας ἰδίᾳ θεῶν
μάλιστα ἄγουσιν ἐν τιμῇ.

³⁹ *Lat. ii.* 421.

⁴⁰ *Lat. i.* 184, 185.

⁴¹ See Berlin Catalogue under *Chersonesus*, and note especially Taf. i. 6.

and l. 51,

σταθῆμεν δὲ αὐτοῦ καὶ εἰκόνα χαλκῆαν ἔν-
οπλον ἐν τῇ ἀκροπόλει παρὰ τὸν τᾶς Παρθέν-
ου βωμὸν καὶ τὸν τᾶς Χερσονάσου.

An inscription from the Tauric Chersonese⁴² dated probably about 150 B.C. contains the formula of the oath taken by magistrates:

ὁμνῶ Δία Γᾶν Ἄλιον Παρθένον θεοὺς Ὀλ-
υμπίους καὶ Ὀλυμπίας.

So we have abundant evidence, even without the literature, for the paramount importance of the cult of Artemis at Chersonesus.

The story of the legendary connection of Artemis with the Tauric Chersonese presents many difficulties. To quote Herodotus first: he says⁴³ that the Tauri sacrifice shipwrecked persons to the Virgin, τὴν δὲ δαίμονα ταύτην τῇ θύουσι λέγουσι αὐτοὶ Ταῦροι Ἰφιγένειαν τὴν Ἀγαμέμνονος εἶναι, on which Stein's comment is 'αὐτοὶ Ταῦροι, nicht die Hellenen.'

Farnell⁴⁴ thinks that the worship of the Tauric Artemis was aboriginal in Attica, and that in any case it cannot have come from the Black Sea originally, as the cult of Brauron points to a very early period, and the Crimea was opened to Greek civilization at a comparatively late time. The worship of Artemis under this aspect seems to have been connected with a very primitive type of idol, and with a vague legend of bloodshed, so he thinks that when the early settlers of the Crimea spread the story of the cruel rites of the native goddess, the similarity of sound in the name of the peninsula and the cult-name at Brauron (probably Ταυροπόλος) caused the identification. Iphigeneia, he thinks, was a local cult-name of Artemis, and he quotes Pausanias,⁴⁵ Ἀρτέμιδος ἐπικλήσιν Ἰφιγενείας ἐστὶν ἱερὸν; also Hesychius, s.v. Ἰφιγένεια ἢ Ἀρτεμις.

However, there is some slight verbal inconsistency, at all events, between this view and that put forward by Farnell himself on the first and second pages of vol. ii.—that the cult of Artemis can be traced back to a prehistoric period, and is found in all the chief places of prehistoric Greek settlement; from which, and from certain most primitive features of the cult, he infers that it was 'an aboriginal inheritance of the Greek nation.' Then he speaks of its diffusion through the various streams of Greek colonization—'it was implanted at an early time . . . in the Tauric Chersonese.' According to Professor Ridgeway⁴⁶ traces of Mycenaean culture have been found along the shore of South Russia. Would it not then be an admissible conjecture that the barbarous goddess of the Crimea was the lineal descendant of the Artemis worshipped by the inhabitants of the same district in the Mycenaean Age, and that the Brauronian Artemis was the descendant of the same divinity in Greece proper? Thus we could account for the resemblances between the

⁴² Quoted by Farnell, *Gk. Cults*, ii. 567 from *Revue des Études Grecques*, 1891, p. 338.

⁴³ iv. 103.

⁴⁴ *Greek Cults*, ii. 452, 3.

⁴⁵ ii. 35, 1.

⁴⁶ *Early Age of Greece*, vol. i. p. 182.

two cults. The influence of the literature that sprang up around the story of Iphigeneia would have its effect, as time went on, and the worship became less primitive, in confirming the position of Artemis as chief goddess of the Chersonese, as we have suggested already in the case of Apollo at Olbia, and his mythical connection with the North. The cult of Heracles at Olbia was no doubt affected in the same way by the literature.

We may judge, then, that the cult of Artemis was of some importance at Olbia, even though we have no direct evidence except the few coins quoted. Perhaps, too, we should be justified in thinking that Artemis must have had some share of special honour in a city of which Apollo was the tutelary deity.

Athene.

Athene may be taken next, as the only other female deity for whose worship at Olbia we have any evidence; though her cult has no connection with that of the four preceding goddesses, who are all, under some of their various aspects, more or less linked. There are no inscriptions from Olbia that mention the name of Athene, and only two from the North Euxine district—a dedication to Athene Σώτειρα at Chersonesus⁴⁷ of the fourth century B.C., and the dedication to Athene Lindia from Neapolis.⁴⁸ However, this has a certain connection with Olbia, as the dedicant is Posideos the son of Posideos, whom we may conclude to be the same as the man who made the dedication to Aphrodite Εὐπλοια at Olbia.

But Athene and the Gorgon are frequent types on the Olbian coins. It is quite likely that the type of Athene had a commercial rather than a religious origin, since Olbia traded especially with Athens, and the Athenian coins would be familiar at Olbia, as through so large a part of the Greek world. Indeed, it is not improbable that the absence of very early coins of Olbia is due to the use of Athenian money, and (perhaps a little later) of the Cyzicene staters, as the regular circulating medium of Olbia, and that the large cast bronze pieces, to which we shall soon refer, were intended to supply small change for home use.⁴⁹ We have some interesting evidence of the money in use at Olbia from an inscription given by Latyshev.⁵⁰ The inscription, which dates from the beginning of the fourth century B.C., is a decree of the people of Olbia for regulating the sale of gold and silver. After decreeing that there shall be free importation and exportation of χρυσίον ἐπίσημον ἢ ἀργύριον ἐπίσημον, the inscription proceeds:

πωλεῖν δὲ καὶ ὠνεῖσθαι πάντα πρὸς τὸ νόμισμα
τὸ τῆς πόλεως, πρὸς τὸν χαλκὸν καὶ τὸ ἀρ-
γύριον τὸ Ὀλβιοπολιτικόν.

⁴⁷ Lat. iv. 82.

⁴⁸ Lat. i. 243.

⁴⁹ Cp. Lenormant, *La Monnaie dans l'Anti-*

quité, vol. i. p. 157.

⁵⁰ Lat. i. 11.

From this it is clear that there was no gold money of Olbia at this date (though gold coins must have come into use soon afterwards, apparently, as another inscription⁵¹ speaks of 1000 gold pieces); and it might perhaps be conjectured that the copper money was more abundant than the silver, as it is mentioned first, and not in order of value, as in the case of the gold and silver at the beginning. A little further down in the same (i. 11) inscription we have:—

τὸ δὲ χρυσίον πωλεῖν καὶ ὠνεῖσθαι τὸν μὲν
στατήρα τὸν Κυζικηνὸν ἔνδεκα τοῦ ἡμιστά-
τήρου καὶ μήτε ἀξιώτερον μήτε τιμιώτε-
ρον, τὸ δ' ἄλλο χρυσίον τὸ ἐπίσημον
ἅπαν καὶ ἀργύριον τὸ ἐπίσημον πωλεῖν καὶ
ὠνεῖσθαι ὡς ἂν ἀλλήλους πείθωσι.

From the special mention of the Cyzicene staters, we should infer that they were the coins in commonest use at Olbia at this period. But the period of the most active intercourse between Olbia and Athens was the earlier one, before the Peloponnesian War—the trade was probably at its height in the time of Herodotus—and it may well have been that the staple medium of exchange at Olbia in the earlier days was the Athenian coinage. A head of Athene is one of the commonest of the counter-marks on Olbian coins; upon which Prof. Percy Gardner has made (privately) the following interesting comment:—‘A counter-mark is often put on a coin to show that it is current at some place where it was not struck. Can this mean that the coin passed at some Athenian factory?’ We long here for some of the knowledge of the commercial history of the North Euxine that Herodotus would have been so competent to give us. He has told us so much of ancient trade, but so little about Olbia and the Greek colonies of this district, there is hardly a trade-reference bearing upon the North Euxine except that to the Scythians⁵² οἱ οὐκ ἐπὶ σιτήσι σπείρουσι τὸν σίτον ἀλλ’ ἐπὶ πρήσει.

At all events most numismatists agree that the large cast bronze pieces are among the earliest of Olbian coins,⁵³ and one of the smaller of these pieces⁵⁴ has a very archaic head of Athene on the obverse. Of the Gorgon-head that appears on several of the other coins of this class we will speak later.

The British Museum catalogue does not describe any coin bearing a head of Athene, and the Berlin collection has only one (No. 133), apparently of late period, though from the very sparing use of dates in that otherwise admirable catalogue, it is frequently difficult to decide the exact period to which the editor would assign any given coin. De Koehne (p. 35) gives four of the cast pieces, similar to that quoted above from Pick, and four bronze struck coins (p. 61). Of these, No. 101 appears to be similar to that given

⁵¹ Lat. i. 12. These need not necessarily have been coins of Olbia, but may have been from Panticapæum or Cyzicus.

⁵² Herod. iv. 17.

⁵³ De Koehne assigns them to the beginning of the fifth century or even earlier.

⁵⁴ Pick, Pl. viii. 1.

by Pick.⁵⁵ It has a head of Pallas on the obverse and an owl on the reverse. The two coins immediately above this in Pick's plate (Nos. 15 and 16) seem also to have heads of Athene; the reverse type on both appears to be an owl. No. 36 in Pick seems to be similar to No. 100 in De Koehne, and to No. 133 in the Berlin collection. The obverse of the Berlin coin shows a head of Pallas, with a branch as counter-mark; on the reverse is a shield and lance. No. 37 in Pick probably represents Athene also; the reverse type is a shield.

This is the principal numismatic evidence for the cult of Athene at Olbia; but the famous medallion found in the North Euxine district,⁵⁶ now in the Hermitage, and representing Athene Parthenos may be also mentioned. It probably came straight from Athens.

No place in the North Euxine district occurs in the register of Athene-cults given by Farnell, but he says⁵⁷—'As in the earliest times we find the worship of Athena in very various parts of the Greek world, we can conclude that she was a primitive Hellenic divinity of the "Achæan" period, and originally worshipped also by the Dorian and Ionic tribes, or adopted by them in their new settlements.' And we know that Athene was worshipped at Miletus, the mother-city of Olbia.⁵⁸ We should of course expect to find Athene held in honour at Miletus, which prided itself on being a colony of Athens, and Miletus in turn would be very likely to transmit the cult to its own colony Olbia, where it would receive a stimulus, if any were needed from the commercial relations between Olbia and Athens.

The Gorgoneion which appears on Olbian coins raises questions or considerable difficulty, both in regard to the type and the deity with which it is connected. The story that Athene herself slew the Medusa is not very early in date; Hesiod does not mention it, and Euripides appears to be the first literary authority for it.⁵⁹ Farnell traces the origin of the story to Athene's interest in Perseus. Furtwängler (in Roscher's Lexicon) states that Athene does not appear on the monuments wearing the Gorgoneion earlier than the seventh century, and thinks there is no earlier literary evidence than this that Athene wore it as a badge, or of its use as an element of terror.⁶⁰ Of course the date for the proved association of Athene with the Gorgon is early enough to allow us to regard the Gorgoneion on Olbian coins as an emblem of Athene; but another view would associate it with Apollo. M. Homolle,⁶¹ in an article on a Gorgon found on the base of a statue at Delos, which he explains as a simple ἀποτρόπαιον, thinks that a close relation existed between Apollo and the Gorgon, and quotes Homer *Iliad* xv. 229, 308, (referring to Apollo's use of the aegis), and Macrobius, i. 17. 67. The latter author, in describing a statue of Apollo at Hierapolis

⁵⁵ Pl. x. 17.

⁵⁶ *Myth. and Monum. of Ancient Athens*, Harrison and Verrall, p. 454.

⁵⁷ *Gk. Culti.* i. p. 259.

⁵⁸ Herod. i. 19.

⁵⁹ *Ion*, 987 *et seq.*

⁶⁰ He regards the two references to the Gorgoneion in the *Iliad*. (xi. 35-6, v. 741) as interpolations.

⁶¹ *Bull. Corr. Hell.* xii. (1888), p. 471. Pl. xii.

says 'Summisque ab humeris gorgoneum velamentum redimitum anguibus tegit scapulas.' M. Homolle remarks that the Gorgon appears on coins with emblems of Apollo, and cites as example the dolphin on Olbian coins. But this seems hardly conclusive, as it has been already seen that the dolphin (or fish-type) occurs on coins of Olbia with deities other than Apollo, *e.g.*, those whose obverse type is a head of Demeter. The question can probably not be decided, but the fact that on the large bronze coins of Olbia the only types are Athene and the Gorgon (including for the moment the beautiful head that appears on the latest of these coins) would seem to be of some weight in guiding us to associate the Gorgoneion on these coins with Athene rather than with Apollo. If we have been right in laying stress on Athenian



FIG. 7.—BRONZE COIN OF OLBIA IN THE BRITISH MUSEUM.

influence in the adoption of Athene as a coin-type at Olbia, this would be another indication in the same direction.

The consideration of the type of the Gorgoneion presents equal difficulties. It seems to have been borrowed from the East about the end of the eighth or beginning of the seventh century B.C.; the earliest example known is a plaque from Cameiros of the seventh century.⁶² The early Gorgons were all of the hideous type, which passed through a period of transition before a beautiful type was elaborated. A series of bronzes discovered on the Acropolis at Athens illustrates these changes; the middle type began at Athens before 480 B.C.⁶³ It is found on the Euxine before 450 B.C. in the valley of the Kuban.⁶⁴ This type grew common in the second half of the

⁶² Daremberg-Saglio, Fig. 3633.

⁶³ Daremberg-Saglio, Fig. 3639.

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⁶⁴ *Compte Rendu*, 1877, Pl. ii. 1, and p. 7.

fifth century.⁶⁵ It should be noted that a type of Gorgoneion like that from the Kuban is found in the Crimea down to the fourth century.⁶⁶ Gold Gorgons were found at Kertsch in graves of the fifth century. The beautiful type of Gorgon's head appears in the fifth century, and becomes common in the fourth; the calm style first, and later the pathetic.⁶⁷

Notwithstanding, however, the undoubted evolution of a more attractive type of Gorgon, I have never been able to feel that the beautiful head on the coin given by Pick⁶⁸ can be a Gorgon. I was glad to find that I had the support of Professor Percy Gardner in this view. He points out (in a private letter) that the wing is wanting. But he has no identification for the type, though he suggests very tentatively a nymph (?). This suggestion seems well worth consideration; anyone who looks at the various full-faced



FIG. 8.—BRONZE COIN OF OLBIA IN THE BRITISH MUSEUM.

heads of nymphs given in Professor Gardner's 'Types of Greek Coins' cannot fail to be struck by the resemblance they bear to the head on this large coin of Olbia. Examine first the head of Arethusa, by the artist Cimon, on a coin of Syracuse,⁶⁹ then the nymph on a coin of Larissa,⁷⁰ and another on a coin of Cyzicus.⁷¹ Certainly the resemblance between these

⁶⁵ See *J.H.S.* xiii. 1892, p. 236, Fig. 4; p. 238, Fig. 10. (note that here Fig. 4 is assigned to the sixth century).

⁶⁶ *Antiq. du Bosp. Cimm.* Pl. xxi. 12, etc.

⁶⁷ An example of the beautiful head, without wings, is given in *Compte Rendu*, 1876, Pl. iii. 28, p. 147.

⁶⁸ *loc. cit.* Pl. viii. 4. It is given in the

Berlin Catalogue, p. 19. A specimen has been added to the British Museum collection since the publication of the catalogue of Olbian coins, and is given in the accompanying Fig. 7.

⁶⁹ *Types of Greek Coins*, Pl. vi. 22.

⁷⁰ *ibid.* Pl. vii. 35.

⁷¹ *ibid.* Pl. x. 46.

heads and that on the Olbian coin is close enough to justify a tentative identification of the latter as a nymph,⁷² thus avoiding the (to my mind) impossible assignation of the type to the Gorgon. I may quote the description of the similar example in the Berlin catalogue No. 2:—

Obverse.

Female head facing, with flying hair and bead necklace, of good style.

Æ 17½

Reverse.

ΟΑΒΗ,⁷³ Eagle on Dolphin, l. head turned to r. with outspread wings.

Below Γ or similar letter.⁷⁴

It will at once be noted that von Sallet in the Berlin catalogue (published 1888) only describes this type as a female head; though the year before in describing this coin⁷⁵ he calls it 'a good specimen of the very rare large cast coins or tokens of Olbia with the female head (Gorgo?) and eagle, of fine style.' It seems fair to conclude from this that in the catalogue von Sallet gives up his doubtful attribution of the previous year. It is also worth noting that he puts this coin *between* No. 1, described as follows (No. 3 in Pick):—

Obverse.

Gorgoneion facing, of archaic style, with tongue protruded.⁷⁶

and No. 3 (No. 2 in Pick):—

Obverse.

Gorgoneion facing, of archaic style, with tongue protruded.

Reverse.

ΑΠΧ with eagle r. which with outstretched wings stands on dolphin.

Æ 17½.

Reverse.

ΑΠΧ in the open spaces of a wheel with four spokes.

(Nos. 4-12 are smaller coins, with more or less similar types.)

If this arrangement is to be regarded as chronological (an uncertain point, from the scarcity of dates in the catalogue, already alluded to), then surely the attribution of the type to the Gorgon becomes impossible, or at least improbable. It is unlikely that two heads of such wholly different types could be in circulation at the same moment in the same city, and be recognized as representing the same object. It should be noted that the Berlin catalogue describes a coin which does not appear in Pick's illustrations (No. 13):—

Obverse.

Gorgoneion, tongue not protruded, of old style.

No. 14 is similar.

Reverse.

ΟΑ . Ι Eagle with raised wings on dolphin, l.

Æ 11.

⁷² On the coins bearing full-face heads of Nymphs, the representatives of a very large class, see Gardner, *loc. cit.* p. 154.

⁷³ Note the occurrence of the town-name in this form.

⁷⁴ De Koehne (p. 35, No. 6) describes a similar

coin as 'Tête de Méduse, d'un style plus moderne et avec une belle expression.'

⁷⁵ *Zeitschr. f. Num.* xiv. 1887, p. 5.

⁷⁶ Cp. similar coin (not the same) in accompanying Fig. 8.

All the above-mentioned coins are large bronze cast pieces. One other coin, a silver one of rather later period, is thus described in the Berlin catalogue, No. 36 :—

<i>Obverse.</i>		<i>Reverse.</i>
Gorgon's head facing, apparently without protruded tongue. ⁷⁷	OABIO over a dolphin, l. KPI	Below .R 2.

Note also that De Koehne⁷⁸ assigns this coin to the beginning of the third century (which is not very different from the date one would conjecture from its position in the Berlin catalogue). Does not this add to the difficulty of regarding the beautiful head on the bronze coin, which is almost certainly of earlier date, as a Gorgon?

Zeus.

The consideration of the cult of Zeus at Olbia must not be deferred longer. At Olbia it seems essential to take Apollo first, and Demeter has a claim to the second position, and then it is most convenient to treat of the other female deities in close connection; so that this seems the place where Zeus may properly be considered. Farnell⁷⁹ may be referred to for some general remarks as to the absence from the monuments of Zeus of distinctive cult-attributes, for his cult was Hellenic pre-eminently, and not local. So we do not expect to have at Olbia titles of such special interest in the case of Zeus as in that of some other gods, though there is at any rate one striking exception in the case of Zeus 'Ολβιος.

The first Olbian inscription which bears the name of Zeus is Lat. i. 12, a decree granting 1000 gold pieces and a statue to Kallinikos the son of Euxenos (dated by Latyshev in the fourth century B.C.) which ends: *ὁ δῆμος Διὶ Σωτήρι*. The name of Zeus Σωτήρ also occurs in two other inscriptions of Olbia, but one⁸⁰ is of the second century after Christ, and the other⁸¹ is a mere fragment.

Lat. i. 91 is a dedication to Zeus Σωτήρ by a private individual of

*εὐχαριστήριον ὑπὲρ εἰρήνης καὶ σωτηρίας
τῆς πόλεως.*

With this may be compared an inscription from Chersonesus⁸² (second century after Christ) where some one whose name is lost

*τὸ τεῖχος ὠικοδόμησεν ἐκ τῶν ἰδίων
Διὶ Σωτήρι ὑπὲρ ἑαυτοῦ καὶ τῆς πόλεως
εὐσταθείας.*

⁷⁷ Is this the same coin as Pick's example, Pl. x. 10?

⁷⁸ Given by De Koehne, *loc. cit.* p. 42 No. 3.
⁷⁹ *Gk. Cults*, i. p. 121, 61.

⁸⁰ Lat. i. 91.

⁸¹ Lat. i. 92.

⁸² Lat. i. 202.

There is one from Panticapaeum⁸³ where the name of Zeus Σωτήρ is joined with *Ἡρα Σώτειρα*; ⁸⁴ it is of the imperial period, and the dedication is made

*ὑπὲρ βασιλέως Τειράνου νείκης.*⁸⁵

There is a fragmentary inscription of the third century B.C. to Zeus Ἐλευθέριος,⁸⁶ a well-known cult-title of Zeus, though not occurring elsewhere in the North Euxine district.

The name of Zeus Βασιλεύς occurs in an inscription given by Latyshev⁸⁷ and assigned by him to the third century B.C. :—

*[ὁ δῆμος] Εὐρησίβιον Δημητρίου Διὶ Βασιλεῖ
[ἀρετῆς] ἔνεκεν καὶ εὐνοίας τῆς εἰς αὐτόν.*⁸⁸

A tower is dedicated to Zeus Πολιάρχης in an inscription given by Latyshev,⁸⁹ assigned by him to the second century after Christ. Farnell⁹⁰ says '(?) third century B.C.' without explaining his reason for the date. This is the only instance he gives of this title, but the cognate one of Zeus Πολιεὺς occurs in many places, notably at Athens. The cult expressed the union of the State.

Perhaps, however, the most interesting title of Zeus for the present enquiry is that of 'Ολβιος, which occurs in an inscription given by Latyshev⁹¹ and assigned by him to the reign of Septimius Severus, 193–211 A.D. It is a decree in honour of Kallisthenes,

*ἱερεὺς δὲ γενόμενος τοῦ προεστώτος τῆς
πόλεως ἡμῶν θεοῦ Διὸς 'Ολβίου.*

This title receives rather curious treatment from Farnell. He says⁹² 'Not only was Zeus the guardian of kingship, but also the protector of the family property, and worshipped as Zeus Κτήσιος. . . . This worship was especially Attic; we find the similar cults of Zeus Πλούσιος in Sparta (Paus. iii. 19. 7) and Zeus 'Ολβιος in Cilicia.' For this latter he quotes an inscription, *circa* 200 B.C., given by Canon Hicks :—⁹³

Διὶ 'Ολβίῳ ἱερεὺς Τεύκρος Ταρκυνίος.

But this is apparently explained by Canon Hicks himself as referring to the priest-kings of *Olbia*, and rather as a local than descriptive epithet. The

⁸³ Lat. ii. 29.

⁸⁴ Cf. the dedication to Athene Σώτειρα at Chersonesus, fourth century B.C., Lat. iv. 82.

⁸⁵ Note that Farnell does not quote any of the above inscriptions in his geographical register.

⁸⁶ Lat. iv. 458.

⁸⁷ i. 105.

⁸⁸ For other references to cult of Zeus Βασί-

λέως, see Pauly-Wissowa, *Real-Encycl.* iii. p. 82, and especially Mr. Greenwell's article, *J.H.S.* vol. ii. p. 78.

⁸⁹ Lat. i. 101.

⁹⁰ *Gk. Cults*, i. p. 161.

⁹¹ Lat. i. 21.

⁹² *Gk. Cults*, i. p. 55.

⁹³ *J.H.S.* 1891, p. 226.

only other reference given by Farnell (he does not mention this inscription from Olbia at all) is *C.I.G.* 2017, a decree from the Thracian Chersonese:—

Κάλλιστος ὑπὲρ τοῦ υἱοῦ Ἀλεξάνδρου Διὶ
ὀλβίῳ εὐχαριστήριον.

on which Boeckh's comment is 'Ζεὺς ὀλβίος non notus.' In this last-mentioned inscription it would seem natural to consider ὀλβίος as a descriptive epithet, and justifiable to compare it with κήσιος; but surely at both Olbia and Olba it must be primarily a local epithet, with no doubt a play upon the meaning of the word. Preller-Robert⁹⁴ say, in commenting on Lat. i. 24, 'Ζεὺς Ὀλβίος seems to be the city god of Olbia.' This again can hardly be correct in the ordinary meaning of the term; we have seen that Apollo was the regular civic deity of Olbia; it would seem to be more exact to say: 'Ὀλβίος, a name under which Zeus was worshipped at Olbia.'⁹⁵

The above titles of Zeus are all that occur in Olbian inscriptions, but one from Neapolis⁹⁶ may also be quoted:—

Διὶ Ἀταβυρίῳ Ποσίδεος Ποσιδέου χαριστήριον.

This Poseidos is no doubt the same man who made the dedication to Aphrodite Εὐπλοία at Olbia. Atabyron was a mountain in Rhodes ἐξ οὗ ὁ Ζεὺς Ἀταβύριος (Steph. Byz.). Athene was worshipped with Zeus Atabyrios at Agrigentum.⁹⁷ Preller-Robert⁹⁸ quote Pindar, *Ol.* vii. 87:—

Ζεῦ πάτερ νότοισιν Ἀταβυρίου μεδέων.

The coins of Olbia which have Zeus as type are neither very numerous nor very interesting. The first given by Pick is Plate xi. No. 3, apparently the same coin as No. 125 in the Berlin catalogue. On the obverse is a laureate head of Zeus; on the reverse is a sceptre ending like a spear below, above, in a lily (or lotus?).

This reverse type is rather curiously described by De Koehne⁹⁹ as 'Flèche, la pointe en bas,' but the object certainly does not much resemble an arrow in Pick's plate. De Koehne also says that the coin probably represents Zeus Soter, but gives no reason for the identification. Nos. 126, 127, in the Berlin catalogue are similar; it is to be assumed from their arrangement both here and in Pick that they are of somewhat late date. The next coin given by Pick¹⁰⁰ has a very fine head of Zeus as the obverse type, and on the reverse an eagle with outspread wings, both apparently in

⁹⁴ (*Gr. Myth.*) I². 867.

⁹⁵ See *Brit. Mus. Cat. of Coins*, Lycania, p. lvi. note, 'Ὀλβίος, a well-known epithet of Zeus, would mean (1) the god of prosperity, (2) the god of Olba,' [or in this case of Olbia]. 'The abstract idea of prosperity is represented by the concrete god Zeus Olbios.' The coins of Olba with throne and thunderbolt of Zeus

Olbios date probably at the end of the first century B.C. and the beginning of the next.

⁹⁶ Lat. i. 242.

⁹⁷ Welcker, *Gr. G.* ii. 282, Polyb. xi. 27.

⁹⁸ *Gr. Myth.* i. 136.

⁹⁹ *loc. cit.* p. 59.

¹⁰⁰ Pl. xi. 4.

rather high relief. Coin No. 5 is similar to (though not the same as) No. 63 in the Berlin Catalogue, which only differs from Pick's coin in having a caduceus as counter-mark on the cheek of Zeus, whose head is the obverse type. The reverse type is an eagle. Coin No. 6 shows the caduceus in front of the head of Zeus. Several Imperial coins representing Zeus seated are described by De Koehne, but only one¹⁰¹ appears in Pick's plates.¹⁰² On the obverse is a seated figure holding a sceptre, on the reverse a standing figure of Fortune, with a horn of plenty and a rudder. Perhaps the sceptre causes De Koehne to identify the type as Zeus: it is described as Apollo in the Berlin catalogue (No. 134).¹⁰³

Hermes.

Hermes may be considered next, as he appears both in inscriptions and on coins of Olbia. Hermes and Apollo were often worshipped side by side, as a brother-pair—Apollo as mouthpiece and prophet of Zeus, Hermes as his outstretched right hand; and so the two stood together in streets and before doors—Apollo as Ἀγνιεύς, Hermes as Ἐνόδιος.¹⁰⁴ So we should expect to find some testimony to the cult of Hermes at Olbia, where Apollo held such a high position. He was the god of trade, markets, and commerce, both by land and sea; therefore a statue of Hermes Ἀγοραίος (whom we shall find mentioned in two Olbian inscriptions) stood in the market-place of every important town.

The earliest inscription found at Olbia referring to Hermes is of the third century B.C.,¹⁰⁵ and begins:

[Νικόδρο]μος Διονυσίου [γυμνασ]ιαρχήσας
[τὸν υἱ]ὸν (?) Διονύσιον Ἑρμ[ῆ] καὶ Ἡρακλεῖ.

This would appear to be a dedication to Hermes in his character of ἀγώνιος.¹⁰⁶

Hermes Agoraios was the god to whom the aediles (ἀγορανόμοι) of Olbia made offerings. Two of these dedicatory inscriptions have come down to us.¹⁰⁷ It is worth while to quote Latyshev's description of the carving above the first of these inscriptions: 'Super titulo Fortunae rota incisa est, infra manu admodum rudi Mercurii protome, dextra marsupium tenentis, sinistra caduceum, utrinque foliola e quibus id, quod ad dextram spectanti est, caput humanum in medio incisum habet.' The end of the inscription may be quoted—after the names of the ἀγορανόμοι:—

Ἑρμῇ Ἀγοραίῳ ἀνέθηκαν Νείκην ἀργυρέαν
ὑπὲρ τῆς πόλεως εὐσταθίας καὶ τῆς
ἐαυτῶν ὑγείας.

¹⁰¹ De Koehne, *loc. cit.* p. 88.

¹⁰² Pl. xi. 22.

¹⁰³ If the attribution to Zeus is accepted, might it be considered as a representation of Zeus Ὀλβίος, in consideration of the reverse type?

¹⁰⁴ Preller-Robert, *Gr. Myth.* i. 385.

¹⁰⁵ Lat. iv. 459.

¹⁰⁶ For references to other places where Hermes and Heracles appear together, see Preller-Robert, i. p. 415, n. 4.

¹⁰⁷ Lat. i. 75, 76.

The second inscription only differs in the names of the archon and ἀγοράνομοι. Both are of quite late period.

Two coins representing Hermes are given by Pick; ¹⁰⁸ there are none in the Berlin collection. Both of Pick's coins have a head of Hermes wearing a petasos as obverse type, but the heads are quite different. No. 32 is very badly struck; if the coin were divided into four quarters, the head would fill little more than the lower quarter at the left; the petasos is much flatter, and more distinct than in No. 33. No. 33 has also a branch as counter-mark behind the head. Both these coins have a winged caduceus as reverse type.

There is another coin which may be referred to here, that of the Scythian king Inismeus, given by Pick, ¹⁰⁹ with a turreted female head (Tyche of Olbia) as reverse type. It is described by De Koehne ¹¹⁰ as having a bearded head of Hermes on the obverse, but the type has none of the characteristics of Hermes, and it is more likely to be a portrait of the king Inismeus. De Koehne assigns this coin to the period of the reconstruction of Olbia, *i.e.*, between 60 B.C. and 193 A.D.

Poseidon.

Strictly speaking, Poseidon can hardly claim to be considered as having a cult at Olbia at all, as no inscriptions bear his name, and it is doubtful whether he is represented on the coins. However, there is an interesting inscription from Panticapaeum, ¹¹¹ in which Πανταλέων ναύαρχος makes a dedication

Ποσιδῶνι Σωσινέ[ω]ι καὶ Ἀφροδίτῃ Ναυαρχίδι,

on which Latyshev's comment is, — 'Dei et deae epitheta, quae in titulo leguntur, primum hic videntur innotuisse.' This connection of Poseidon with Aphrodite has already been referred to under Aphrodite Εὔπλοια.

De Koehne ¹¹² gives two coins which he considers represent Poseidon. The first (No. 43) he describes as follows:—

Obverse.
Tête de Poseidon.

Reverse.
Hache, Goryte, Carquois.

He admits, however, that the head might be identified as Zeus. But surely the presence of the battle-axe and bow in case on the reverse makes its identification as the Borysthenes more likely. ¹¹³

The other coin quoted by De Koehne (No. 44) appears to be that given by Pick (Pl. ix. 24). It is thus described by De Koehne:—

¹⁰⁸ Pl. x. 32, 33. See also De Koehne, *loc. cit.*

¹⁰⁹ Pl. p. 66.

¹¹⁰ Pl. xii. 9.

¹¹¹ *loc. cit.* i. 71.

¹¹² Lat. ii. 25.

¹¹³ *loc. cit.* p. 44. 45.

¹¹⁴ This is apparently the coin given by Pick, Pl. ix. 32.

Obverse.
Tête de Poseidon, à gauche.

Reverse.
ΟΛΒΙ. Dauphin, à gauche, en bas,
ΦΟ.

If it were not for the dolphin on the reverse, this head might easily be taken for the river-god, (and indeed this attribution is suggested in the Berlin catalogue, No. 66) as the forehead, where the horns would come, is indistinct. But as the series of Borysthenes coins has a battle-axe and bow in case as reverse type, it seems possible to assign this head to Poseidon. His cult would be likely to be of some importance as Olbia, both because it was a maritime town, and because in Ionia the worship of Poseidon held a chief place. ¹¹⁴

Dionysus.

There is no doubt about the right of Dionysus to a place among the cult-deities of Olbia, as we have Herodotus' ¹¹⁵ authority for the fact of the celebration of his mysteries there, for through this came about the death of the Scythian king Scyles.

Also there is an inscription referring to the Dionysia at Olbia, the decree in honour of Kallinikos ¹¹⁶ already referred to, which concludes:—

τὸν δὲ στέφανον ἀναγορευθῆναι
τοῖς Διονυσίοις ἐν τῷ θεάτρῳ.

This decree is assigned by Latyshev to the fourth century B.C. The name of Dionysus also occurs in two Panticapaeum inscriptions. ¹¹⁷ The latter is especially interesting; it consists of the words,

Διονύσω[ι]
Ἀ]ρείῳ.

This title of Dionysus was only known before from an Orphic hymn (30. 4); Latyshev dates the inscription, (which was found in 1892), in the fourth century B.C.

It is perhaps surprising that Dionysus does not appear on Olbian coins; but on the vase-paintings found in this region Dionysus and Ariadne and kindred subjects are of frequent occurrence. ¹¹⁸

¹¹⁴ Among other references may be given Herod. i. 148, Paus. vii. 24. 5, (Frazer's note), *Myth. d. Arch. Inst.* 10. (1885), p. 32, *Bull. Corr. Hell.* 13. (1889), p. 279.

¹¹⁵ Herod. iv. 78, 79.—an important passage in many ways, illustrating as it does the high degree of Greek civilization attained at Olbia, and the impression it produced on the Scythian king. Rawlinson (*ad. loc.*) says, 'The Milesian

colonists seem to have carried the worship of the Phrygian Bacchus (Sabazius) to Olbia. Hence Olbia itself was called Σαβία or Σαβία, (Peripl. P. Eux. p. 151)'—surely a most improbable derivation.

¹¹⁶ Lat. i. 12.

¹¹⁷ Lat. ii. 18, iv. 199.

¹¹⁸ *Compte Rendu* (passim) and *Antiq. Bosp. Cimm.* c.g. Pl. lx.

Ares.

The claim of Ares to a place in this discussion is doubtful. We have the well-known passage of Herodotus,¹¹⁹ already referred to,—the temple of brushwood and the worship of the ancient sword. But in the first place it is by no means certain that this was a worship of Ares at all; it sounds much more like a savage sword-worship; and in the second, even if it were proved that Ares was a special object of cult among the Scythians, it would still not follow that such was the case at Olbia also. Nor are there any Olbian inscriptions which refer to Ares.

However, there is some numismatic evidence for the cult. Three coins are given in the Berlin catalogue (Nos. 136–138), with a standing figure of



FIG. 9.—BRONZE COIN OF OLBIA IN THE BERLIN MUSEUM.

Ares as a reverse type. The first of these coins, No. 136, is reproduced here (Fig. 9).¹²⁰ The reverse is thus described in the Berlin catalogue:—

ΟΛΒΙΟΠ ΟΛΕΙΤΩΝ. Ares, standing, r., left hand leaning on lance. A in field to left.

There is a bust of Geta on the obverse; the other two Berlin coins are similar. This coin De Koehne¹²¹ thinks represents the temple-statue of Achilles Pontarches, but there does not seem any ground for the assignation. Another coin given by Pick,¹²² which does not appear in the Berlin catalogue, is also assigned to Achilles by De Koehne, but the figure, which is standing and holding a lance, seems more likely to be Ares. It looks like the copy of an archaic statue. The reverse type of this coin is a caduceus. These coins are all of late period.

Helios.

There is some very interesting numismatic evidence for the existence of this cult at Olbia. Coin No. 114¹²³ in the Berlin Catalogue is thus described:—

<i>Obverse.</i>	<i>Reverse.</i>
Head of Helios, facing, with rays.	OA above two fore-parts of horses
Æ 5.	set back to back.

¹¹⁹ Herod. iv. 59, 62.

¹²⁰ The cast from which this photograph was made, was obtained through the kindness of Dr. H. Dressel, of the Royal Museum at Berlin, as were others referred to below.

It appears in Pick's plates (xii. i.).

¹²¹ *Loc. cit.* i. p. 84.

¹²² Pl. xi. 21.

¹²³ Nos. 115, 116 are similar.

This coin is given by Pick;¹²⁴ it is apparently of rather early date. Von Sallet comments that these coins show traces of the rise of another type at Olbia. De Koehne¹²⁵ also describes them, and says that they are the only record we have of a cult of Helios here.¹²⁶ He thinks that this cult was introduced from Sinope to Olbia; as a coin of Sinope¹²⁷ has a head of Helios, and on another coin a head with ΞΙΝΩΠ[ΕΩΝ] between the rays occurs as counter-mark.¹²⁸ It would seem more probable that the worship was introduced from Rhodes,¹²⁹ the special home of the cult of Helios. We have an apparent instance of the intimate relations between the two states at a rather later period in the inscriptions set up by Posideos which have been so often referred to. Another proof of the commercial intercourse between Rhodes and Olbia is the fact that jar-handles have been found near the latter city stamped with the name of Rhodes;¹³⁰ as these, however, have been found in almost every part of the Greek world, the argument from them cannot be pressed.

There are no Olbian inscriptions which show the name of Helios, but there is one from Panticapaeum¹³¹ of late period, and one from Gorgippia,¹³² of 41 A.D., both of which relate to the manumission of slaves. In each of these the same formula occurs.—

ὑπὸ Δία, Γῆν, Ἥλιον.

For this formula Latyshev¹³³ compares an inscription from Thermae in Aetolia,¹³⁴ which also refers to the manumission of a slave.

The Dioscuri.

Head¹³⁵ says that the worship of the Dioscuri was very prevalent on the shores of the Euxine. We have two pieces of evidence for the existence of the cult at Olbia. One is a marble tablet, on which is a fragmentary inscription of the third or second century B.C.¹³⁶ Above the inscription are the two caps of the Dioscuri, and half a star, with apparently the remains of another half. The other is a coin, given by Pick (Pl. X. 31), of which there are two examples in the Berlin Catalogue (No. 67, 68). The reverse of this coin shows a dolphin between the caps of the Dioscuri, and above a

¹²⁴ Pl. ix. 31.

¹²⁵ *loc. cit.* p. 58, 59.

¹²⁶ Note that the Berlin catalogue gives a coin, No. 32, with Heracles as a reverse type, and 'over the head a small round counter-mark with youthful Helios-head with rays.'

¹²⁷ Mionnet, Suppl. iv. p. 574, 131.

¹²⁸ *British Museum Catalogue*, 'Pontus,' Pl. xxii. 15 (date circa. B.C. 290–250).

¹²⁹ But note the possible adoption from Sinope of the eagle standing on fish, as reverse type, referred to under Demeter.

¹³⁰ Büchsenhützel, *Besitz und Erwerb*, p. 422–4. See *Inscr. Graec. Insul. Maris Aeg.* i. p. 175, (appendix on Rhodian jar-handles), also an exhaustive article by Becker, (*Mélanges Gréco-Rom.* vol. i. p. 416).

¹³¹ Lat. ii. 54.

¹³² Lat. ii. 400.

¹³³ i. 98.

¹³⁴ Dittenberger, *Syll.* ii. 837 (2nd edit.).

¹³⁵ *Historia Numorum*, p. 235, (under Istros).

¹³⁶ Latyshev, i. 18, *C.I.G.* ii. add. p. 1000. No. 2083. b.

large star. De Koehne¹³⁷ explains the dolphin as emblematic of the connection of the Dioscuri with the sea as the protectors of mariners. He gives several coins of Panticapaeum which bear their symbols; they also appear very frequently on the coins of Tanais, and of Dioscurias in Colchis. From their connection with navigation, too well known to require illustration, we should naturally expect to find a cult of the Dioscuri at Olbia, and the marble and the coin supply sufficient confirmatory evidence.

The Cabiri.

The Cabiri must be taken next to the Dioscuri, in view of their close relationship. A very interesting inscription relating to this cult at Olbia was discovered in 1897.¹³⁸ It is on a base of white marble, and is assigned by Latyshev to the second century B.C. It is as follows:—

Εὐβίωτος Ἀρίστωνος
Ἐπικράτη(ν) Νικηράτου
τὸν θεῖον
θεοῖς τοῖς ἐν Σαμοθράκη[ι]
ἱερησάμενον.

This is the only mention of the cult of the Cabiri at Olbia, and apparently in the whole North Euxine district, so it is of special importance. A cult of the Cabiri at Miletus is known,¹³⁹ apparently in the temple of the Didymaeon Apollo, and it may have come to Olbia from the mother city; or direct from Samothrace, as the form of the inscription (θεοῖς τοῖς ἐν Σαμοθράκη[ι]) would suggest. We have seen that Demeter, Hermes, and Dionysus, and possibly the Dioscuri, were all objects of cult at Olbia, and as these deities were bound up with the Samothracian worship it is natural that a cult of the Cabiri should be found there also.

Asklepios.

There are two pieces of evidence for the existence of a cult of Asklepios at Olbia. The first is merely incidental,—the reference in the Protogenes decree¹⁴⁰ to τὸν [πύργον] Ἐπιδαυρίου, from which it has been supposed that there was a temple of Asklepios near by, which gave its name to the tower. The other,—the bas-relief found at Olbia, and referred to by De Koehne¹⁴¹—is more important. Mr. Rouse¹⁴² conjecturally suggests that the seated

¹³⁷ *loc. cit.* p. 57.

¹³⁸ *Lat. iv. 27.* Note that Latyshev thinks the absence of the (ν) in the 2nd. line is the stonemason's error, as it would be unusual for the uncle's name to be omitted.

¹³⁹ *C.I.G.* 2882.

¹⁴⁰ *Lat. i. 16, B. 46.*

¹⁴¹ *loc. cit.* p. 7. The relief is given by Uvarov *Recherches sur les Antiquités de la Russie méridionale*, 120, Taf. 13.

¹⁴² *Greek Votive Offerings*, p. 20. Mr. Rouse is here following the author of the article Heros in Roscher's *Lexicon* (i. 2571), who suggests the attribution of the relief to Achilles.

figure in this relief is Achilles. But an examination seems to make this impossible; on the wall hangs the representation of a human trunk,¹⁴³ apparently dedicated as a votive offering. This is surely decisive in favour of regarding Asklepios as the subject of the relief. Uvarov considered this relief as the most important work of the kind found at Olbia. These two items of evidence seem enough to make good the claim of Asklepios to a place among the cult deities of Olbia, which his close connection with Apollo would make probable even without such direct testimony.

We have two inscriptions from the Euxine district referring to Asklepios; one, of Roman period, from Chersonesus,¹⁴⁴ directs that a copy of the decree shall be placed

ἐν τῷ ἱερῷ τοῦ Ἀσκληπιοῦ.

The other is from Panticapaeum,¹⁴⁵ and may be quoted in full.

Θεῶ Ἀσκληπιῷ σωτῆρι καὶ εὐεργέτῃ
τὴν τράπεζαν ἀνέστησε Στρατόδημος
Μενεστράτου.

Achilles Pontarches.

The question as to whether the cult of Achilles Pontarches at Olbia was of Greek or Scythian origin has been already discussed in the Introduction; it remains now to deal with the epigraphic and other evidence for the existence of the cult at Olbia. Dion Chrysostom¹⁴⁶ is the literary authority for this; he says:—τοῦτον [*i.e.* Achilles] μὲν γὰρ ὑπερφυῶς τιμῶσι, καὶ νεῶν τὸν μὲν ἐν τῇ νήσῳ τῇ Ἀχιλλέως καλουμένῃ ἱδρυνται, τὸν δὲ ἐν τῇ πόλει, ὥστε οὐδὲ ἀκούειν ὑπὲρ οὐδενὸς ἄλλου θέλουσιν ἢ Ὀμήρου. καὶ ἅλλα οὐκέτι σαφῶς ἐλληνίζοντες διὰ τὸ ἐν μέσοις οἰκεῖν τοῖς βαρβάροις ὅμως τὴν γε Ἰλιάδα ὀλίγον πάντες ἴσασιν ἀπὸ στόματος. It is not quite clear whether Dio here means by 'the island of Achilles' Leuke or Berezan, a small island at the mouth of the Borysthenes. Escher¹⁴⁷ and Fleischer¹⁴⁸ both take the view that Berezan is meant,¹⁴⁹ and it seems on the whole more likely. There was, of course, also a temple on the island of Leuke. Leuke and Berezan have constantly been confused, both by ancient and modern writers, with each other, and with the δρόμος Ἀχιλλέως,—a narrow tongue of land south of Olbia and the mouth of the Borysthenes, with its west end in the sea, and its east in a bay, and only joined to the mainland by a narrow strip

¹⁴³ See Mr. Rouse himself, *loc. cit.* p. 210-212, on the custom 'of dedicating models of the diseased part. . . Votive eyes. . . make up two-fifths of the whole number. Next to the eye comes the trunk.'

¹⁴⁴ *Lat. i. 189.*

¹⁴⁵ *Lat. ii. 30.*

¹⁴⁶ *Orat. xxxvi. 439. M.*

¹⁴⁷ In Pauly-Wissowa, *Real-Encycl.* s.v.

Achilleus.

¹⁴⁸ In Roscher's *Lex. s.v.* Achilleus.

¹⁴⁹ This is the view of Koehler, but Latyshev thinks Leuke is meant (*op. cit.* i. p. 167). It should be noted that *C.I.G.* 2. 2076 (= *Lat. i. 77*), which Fleischer quotes as being found on Berezan, Latyshev says is of uncertain attribution.

of land in the middle. All three places were sacred to Achilles Pontarches. From so late an author as Dio, of course, nothing can be proved as to the antiquity of the cult, except that one of such importance was not very likely to be of recent introduction. That Achilles was from very early times worshipped as the tutelary deity of the North Euxine we know from the line of Alcaeus already quoted. We have no very early Olbian inscription referring to Achilles, but one very important one¹⁵⁰ is dated by Latyshev early in the first century B.C.; and is undoubtedly of the period before the city was destroyed, *i.e.* probably 150 years before Dio's visit. The inscription in question is a decree in honour of Nikeratos, son of Papias, who had protected the citizens from the enemy, and now was decreed a public funeral. In it the words occur:—*ἐν τῷ . . . ἀγῶνι τὰχιλλεὶ κατὰ τὸ πυθόχρηστον τῆς ἱπποδρομίας.*

Though this is the earliest Achilles-inscription from Olbia itself, we have a much earlier one from close at hand. At the mouth of the Borysthenes and Hypanis rivers was the Alsos Hecates, a sandy tongue of land at the end of the peninsula now called Kinburn. In the sea at some distance to the west of this point, some fishermen in 1885 dragged up in their nets a stone altar, with the inscription

Ἀχιλλεῖ
τὸμ βωμὸν
καὶ τὸ κέδρον.¹⁵¹

Latyshev dates this as fourth or certainly third century B.C. It is of great interest and importance, as indicating that the cult of Achilles on the North Euxine was even more widespread than had been thought.¹⁵² It would seem that there must have been a temple, or at least an altar, of Achilles, at the Alsos Hecates, where he was worshipped probably by fishermen, as the tongue of land does not appear to have been inhabited. However, as the altar was found at some distance out at sea, the sand-bank may have shifted its position.

We have an inscription of the same date or a little earlier (fourth century B.C.) from the island of Leuke,¹⁵³ a dedication by a citizen of Olbia to Achilles:—

[Ὁ δεῖνα Δη]μοστράτο(ν) Ἀχιλλεῖ
[Λευκ]ῆς μεδέοντι Ὀλβιοπολίτ[η]ς,

which may be taken as evidence of the existence of the cult in Olbia itself in comparatively early times.¹⁵⁴ Also there was found on the island of Leuke an important decree¹⁵⁵ of the people of Olbia in honour of some person, apparently an inhabitant of the island, dated by Latyshev at the end of the fourth or beginning of the third century B.C. A fragmentary proxenos-

¹⁵⁰ i. 17.

¹⁵¹ Lat. iv. 63.

¹⁵² Note also a fragmentary inscription from Neapolis of the second century B.C.; apparently a dedication to Achilles (Lat. iv. 191).

¹⁵³ Lat. i. 172.

¹⁵⁴ For the form of the dedication cp. the one at Neapolis by Posideos Ἀχιλλεῖ νῆσου [μεδέοντι]. Lat. i. 244.

¹⁵⁵ Lat. i. 171.

inscription¹⁵⁶ of the same period, found at Olbia, he also thinks refers to some inhabitant of Leuke. But according to ancient authors the island was deserted, and sailors were forbidden to spend the night there,¹⁵⁷ from which it would seem that the persons honoured by these decrees were priests or curators of the temple of Achilles at Leuke. If the island mentioned by Dio was Leuke, it might be inferred that the temple there was in charge of the people of Olbia.

For the importance of the cult in the later period of the city we have abundant evidence in the series of dedicatory inscriptions given by Latyshev,¹⁵⁸ belonging probably to the second or third century after Christ. These inscriptions, though not found actually on the site of Olbia,¹⁵⁹ Latyshev thinks quite certainly belong to the city, both from the similarity of the formulas to those of undoubtedly Olbian inscriptions, and also because nearly all the names given in these inscriptions are found in others from Olbia. Some have thought this series belonged to the town of Odessos, but it was too small to have had five archons and six praetors, or to have had the games referred to in some of the inscriptions. One curious point of contrast between these inscriptions and those to Apollo Prostates, which belong to the same period, is that in the latter the gift is always mentioned, whereas in the former it is merely called *χαριστήριον*; except in 81, where it is a *στέφανος*, (given by a priest), and in 77, where even *χαριστήριον* is omitted. No. 79 may be quoted as an example of these inscriptions:—

Ἀγαθῇ τύχῃ Ἀχιλλεῖ Ποντάρχῃ
οἱ περὶ Καλλισθένην Σατύρου στρατηγοί,
Μηνόδαρος Ποντικοῦ,
Νάβαζος Νουμηνίου,
Ἀχιλλεὺς Συν(τ)ρόφου,
Βάδαγος Ἰεξδράδου,
Δάδαγος Κουζαίου,
ὑπὲρ τῆς πόλεως εὐσταθίας καὶ τῆς
ἐαυτῶν ὑγείας χαριστήριον.

No. 82 is worthy of note, because the dedication is to Ἀχιλλεῖ Ποντάρχῃ καὶ Θέτιδι. A cult of Achilles, Thetis, and the Nereids is known at Erythrae in Ionia.¹⁶⁰

It should be noticed that the name Achilles is of frequent occurrence at Olbia; twelve instances of it appear in the inscriptions given by Latyshev.

Whether we have any numismatic evidence for the cult of Achilles at Olbia is doubtful. De Koelne¹⁶¹ gives three coins which he thinks represent

¹⁵⁶ Lat. i. 13.

¹⁵⁷ Scyl. *Peripl.* 68; Arrian. *Per.* 32; Anon.

Peripl. 66; Amm. Marc. xxii. 8, 35; Max.

Tyr. diss. xx. 7; Philostr. *Heroic.* 20, 35.

¹⁵⁸ i. 77-83, iv. 17-19.

¹⁵⁹ For the dispersion of the stones of Olbia,

Latyshev quotes Uvarov, (*Rosh.* p. 32). Lat. iv. 18, is said actually to have been found among the ruins of Olbia.

¹⁶⁰ Dittenberger, *Syll.* 2 600; Michel, *Recueil*, 839, B. 2, 27.

¹⁶¹ *loc. cit.* i. p. 84, 85, 88.

Achilles. Two of these we have already seen are with more probability assigned to Ares. The third coin may possibly represent Achilles. It appears to be similar to that given by Pick, Pl. xii. 2, but not the same coin. De Koehne describes the reverse type of this coin thus:—

ΟΛΒΙΟΠΟΛΕΙΤΩΝ. Homme nu, tourné à gauche, posant le pied droit sur une élévation et tenant dans la droite un objet indistinct. Devant lui une *metu*. Dans le champ Γ.

If the object really is a *metu*, the coin may reasonably be assigned to Achilles, and would be the solitary instance of his appearance upon the coins of Olbia.

Heracles.

The head of Heracles is a not infrequent type on Olbian coins. We should expect to find him a special object of worship at Olbia, in view of his connection with the North, familiar enough from Pindar (*Olymp.* iii.), with which may be compared the passage where Herodotus says that the Greeks dwelling about the Pontus relate that Heracles, after taking the cattle of Geryon, passed through Scythia, and then came ἐς τὴν Ἰταλίαν καλεομένην γῆν,¹⁶² recalling at once Pindar's

τόθι δένδρεα θάμβαινε σταθείς.

Herodotus also relates¹⁶³ that in Exampaeus, a district not far from Olbia, was shown a footprint of Heracles: however, throughout Greek lands Heracles seems to have had attributed to him objects similar to those which in England are usually assigned to the devil,—the Devil's Arrows, Devil's Punchbowl, etc.—so the footprint here has most likely no particular significance. His cult was so widespread that we have probably no right to claim any special local importance for it at Olbia, but his legendary connection with the North, as in the case of Apollo, would make him seem a fitting object of worship there.

The epigraphic evidence for the cult of Heracles at Olbia is rather curious. Latyshev¹⁶⁴ gives an inscription which is carved on a stone very similar to the gravestones in use at Athens in the fourth century B.C., and apparently made of Attic marble. It has been thought, therefore, that the block may have been sent out to Olbia from Athens for sepulchral purposes and then, having for some reason or other not been thus used, may have been appropriated to this dedication. The inscription is most fragmentary and was evidently purposely defaced in antiquity; it is restored thus by Latyshev:—

[Κλεόμβροτος Παντακλέους
ἀνέθ]ηκε τ[ὸν πύρ-
ρον] Ἡ[ρ]α[κλε]ῖ
[καὶ] τῶι δῆμ[ω]ι.

¹⁶² iv. 8, 9.

¹⁶³ Herod. iv. 82.

¹⁶⁴ *loc. cit.* i. 99. It should be said also

that on the other side is an inscription of much later date, given i. 67.

Then follows an epigram of six lines, of which the first two may be quoted:—

Ἡράκ[λ]ε[ς], σοὶ [τ]όνδε Κλεόμβροτος εἶσ[α]τ[ο] π[ύρ]ρον
καὶ δῆμαι, ποταμ[οῦ] τ[οῦ]δε [π]α[ρ]᾽ ἡ[δ]ύνα[ς].

(We have instances of towers being built by private individuals in the Protogenes decree¹⁶⁵). The inscription¹⁶⁶ in which Hermes and Heracles are mentioned together has already been noticed. It is curious that in this also there are signs that it was wilfully destroyed, from which, Latyshev says, it might be conjectured that at some time or other the cult of Heracles was abolished at Olbia, and his name upon the monuments erased.

Inscriptions from some other places on the North Euxine contain the name of Heracles.¹⁶⁷ One from Panticapaeum,¹⁶⁸ of the year 216 A.D., begins:—Τὸν ἀφ' Ἡρακλέους καὶ Εὐμόλπου τοῦ Ποσειδῶνος καὶ ἀπὸ προγόνων βασιλέων βασιλέα Τιβέριον Ἰούλιον Ῥησκούποριν.

This legendary genealogy would seem to explain why the various emblems of Poseidon and Heracles are found on the coins of the Kings of the Bosphorus.¹⁶⁹

With regard to the numismatic evidence for the cult of Heracles at Olbia, eight coins bearing his head are given by De Koehne, seven are reproduced in Pick's plates, and there are three in the Berlin catalogue (none in the British Museum). Pick's examples fall into two sharply defined classes. Three coins¹⁷⁰ have youthful heads of Heracles, with the lion-skin; the types are different, but they are all of fairly good style, all beardless, and all looking to the right; the reverse of each is a club. The first two examples in Pick are silver, and resemble No. 32 in the Berlin catalogue; the third is copper, and is similar to Nos. 117, 118 in the Berlin catalogue. No. 117 is thus described:—

Obverse.

Youthful head of Heracles, with lionskin, r. Two faint round counter-marks.

Reverse.

ΟΛΒΙΟ above a club horizontally placed. Below ΕΙΘΒΑ. (Æ 5).

Von Sallet thinks that ΒΑ on the reverse of this coin perhaps stands for βασιλεύς, either a priest's title, or a reference to the Scythian kings. The latter seems more likely, in view of the last-quoted inscription from Panticapaeum, as other Scythian kings besides those of the Bosphorus may have claimed descent from Heracles.

The other four coins given by Pick¹⁷¹ have heads of quite a different style from the preceding, and with differing reverse types. They are all

¹⁶⁵ Latyshev, i. 16.

¹⁶⁶ *Lat.* iv. 459.

¹⁶⁷ *Lat.* i. 245, from Nikita, probably 3rd century B.C.; *Lat.* ii. 24, from Panticapaeum of 4th century B.C.; and *Lat.* ii. 350, from Phanagoria of 2nd century B.C.

¹⁶⁸ *Lat.* ii. 41. There are two similar from Phanagoria, ii. 358, 361.

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¹⁶⁹ Perhaps the dedication from Panticapaeum (*Lat.* iv. 200) to Διὶ Γενάρχη should be compared with this.

¹⁷⁰ Pl. x. 18-20; cp. Berlin Catalogue, 32, 117, 118.

¹⁷¹ Pl. x. 21-25; cp. De Koehne, *loc. cit.* p. 48. No. 54.

silver, and the heads on the obverse are of a coarse heavy type, all turned to the left, and more or less similar. The reverse type of Pick's example, No. 21, is a vertical club enclosed in a wreath formed by two ears of corn; No. 22 has a wreath; No. 24 a bow in case placed over a club, and No. 23 a vertical bow in case.¹⁷²

It is perhaps worth while to note, in discussing Heracles' connection with Olbia, that the name *Καλλίνικος*, which so often occurs in literature as an epithet of Heracles, appears twice in Olbian inscriptions,¹⁷³ both of early date.

The River-god Borysthenes.

We have more numismatic evidence of this cult than of any other represented on Olbian coins, except that of Apollo; judging from the number of specimens contained in all the collections, more coins must have been struck with the head of the Borysthenes upon them than with any other type. The Berlin collection has 26 out of a total of 126 (besides several acquired since the appearance of the catalogue); the British Museum 9 out of 23; the Fitzwilliam Museum at Cambridge 4 out of 7; and De Koehne, out of about 160 coins, has 26 (which he assigns to the river Hypanis). This predominance of the river-god at Olbia is readily explained by the consideration that in South Russia the rivers are by far the most imposing natural features of the country,¹⁷⁴ and as such would be almost certain to become objects of worship to the early settlers. We know from Herodotus¹⁷⁵ that the Scythians worshipped the Danube. Of the Borysthenes in particular Professor Percy Gardner¹⁷⁶ says:—'We find traces of a peculiar veneration paid by the Greek colonists of Olbia to the river Borysthenes, whose head appears on their coins. This head is clearly modified in type in imitation of the physiognomy of the Scythians who inhabited the steppes of the river, and to whose physiognomy it bears a striking resemblance.' These Scythian characteristics of the coin-types will be easily seen from the accompanying illustration (Fig. 10). Rivers have such a distinctively local character that it is particularly easy to personify them. They often appear on coins in the form of a bull. Can the striding bull, which is the obverse type of an Olbian coin, be taken as a personification of the river-god?¹⁷⁷ This hardly seems likely, in view of the other series of Borysthenes coins, but the coin is apparently quite late. There is another coin, of Imperial date, which has a bull as reverse type.¹⁷⁸ The series in the illustration belongs to another type,—a human figure, with human face and a shaggy beard, but

¹⁷² Of these coins De Koehne says, 'Les dernières pièces de ce type indiquent déjà une époque de décadence.'

¹⁷³ Lat. i. 12, 114.

¹⁷⁴ Cp. Herod. iv. 47; *et seq.* and esp. iv. 82, *Θαλάττιά δὲ ἢ χάρις αὐτῇ οὐκ ἔχει, χωρίς δὲ ποταμούς τε πολλὰ μεγίστους καὶ ἀριθμὸν πλείστους.*

¹⁷⁵ Herod. iv. 59.

¹⁷⁶ *Transactions of Royal Soc. of Literature*, vol. xi. second series, p. 174, *et seq.*

¹⁷⁷ Pick, Pl. xi. 23, Berlin Catalogue, 132, De Koehne, *loc. cit.* p. 84, explains it as referring to the fact that the wealth of Olbia largely consisted in cattle.

¹⁷⁸ Pick, Pl. xii. 3.

with the forehead, horns, and ears of an ox.¹⁷⁹ At Olbia, however, no more than the head appears on the coins.

The coins¹⁸⁰ themselves can be best discussed with reference to the accompanying Fig. 10; they are only differentiated in the Berlin and British Museum Catalogues by the monograms on the reverse, but the heads of the river-gods on the obverse are of very different types.

The first coin (*a*) illustrated¹⁸¹ is not Scythian in type; the artist seems to have been anxious to get as close to the bull-form as possible; it is a bull's head slightly humanised. The forehead with its short horns and the beard are especially bovine. One would suppose that here the die-cutter was copying a type from another coin; at all events there is nothing local about it.

The second coin (*c*)¹⁸² shows a head which is an approximation to the Scythian type, but the forehead and short horns are still those of a bull; the



FIG. 10.—BRONZE COINS OF OLBIA IN THE BERLIN MUSEUM.

bull's ears are less distinct than in No. 1. The hair is still of the conventional river-god type, and looks as if it were dripping.

The head on the obverse of the third coin (*d*)¹⁸³ is rather curious; it is now wholly human, except for the short horns on the forehead which mark the river-god, and the human ears are very clear. But the type is more conventional and less Scythian than the two which follow. It seems surprising

¹⁷⁹ Professor Jebb, on *Βούρρυπος*, Sophocles, *Trach.* 13. The Achelous appears thus on an archaic coin of Metapontum in Lucania, Millingen, *Anc. Coins of Grk. Cities and Kings*, Pl. i. 21. The coin given by Head, *Hist. Num.* p. 63, is not the same.

¹⁸⁰ The casts from which these photographs were made were furnished by the kindness of Dr. Dressel.

¹⁸¹ Pick, Pl. ix. 26 (Imhoof-Blumer collection).

¹⁸² Pick, ix. 27 (obverse only; the reverse numbered 27, belongs to the third coin (*d*) in the present illustrations), Imhoof-Blumer collection. An example is in the British Museum, No. 10, cut on p. 12 (Catal. 'Thrace').

¹⁸³ Imhoof-Blumer collection.

that Pick should not have given this head among his examples, as it is quite distinctive.

The next coin (*e*)¹⁸⁴ is perhaps the most typically Scythian of the five; the coin is not struck evenly, so no room is left for the horns to show. No doubt they were on the die, but everything else about the head is as human, and as Scythian, as possible, of the type from which the well-known heads of Pan on the coins of Panticapaeum were developed. The Scythians on the vase of Xenophantos, already referred to, are of the same general type; compare too the wounded Scythians on a very interesting piece of gold work from South Russia.¹⁸⁵ The left-hand figure of the four has a profile very like the second head in the coins represented here.

The last (*f*) of the Borysthene coins¹⁸⁶ represented here also shows distinctly Scythian features, but the horns are plainly seen, and the hair is more like that of the conventional river-god.

All these coins have similar reverse types (*b*),—a battle-axe and bow in case,¹⁸⁷—so the Scythian river-god is associated with the Scythian weapons, and the obverse and reverse types are alike purely local.¹⁸⁸ This is the special interest possessed by this series of coins; like the representations of Scythians on the vases, it shows that there were artists at Olbia who portrayed the men they saw around them, instead of merely perpetuating conventional types. It has already been urged that the appearance of these Scythian heads among others that are wholly Greek seems to show a racial feeling on the part of the artist, which would indicate that Olbia remained a purely Greek city, at any rate during its earlier and more prosperous days. These coins are said in the British Museum catalogue to be earlier than the time of Alexander the Great; De Koehne thinks that they extend over a period of more than a century. When once a mixed population of Greeks and Scythians had arisen, naturally this type would not be perpetuated on the coins. But we should have expected that the Borysthene would have continued in some form or other as a coin-type, considering in how large a measure the prosperity of the city depended on the river. It must be remembered, too, that one of the city's names, and apparently the earliest, was Borysthene. Herodotus speaks of the city by this name in his narrative of Scyles, and also calls the townsmen Borysthenites, though he notices¹⁸⁹ that they preferred to call themselves Olbiopolitans. The actual name Olbia is not found in Herodotus.

¹⁸⁴ In the Berlin collection, but not in the catalogue; Pick's coin (Pl. ix. 28) is similar, but not the same.

¹⁸⁵ *Comptes Rendus*, 1864, p. 142.

¹⁸⁶ Berlin Catalogue, No. 93, Pick's coin, Pl. ix. 29, is not unlike this, but the resemblance is not very close.

¹⁸⁷ The coin given by Pick (Pl. ix. 32) already noted as being ascribed by De Koehne to Poseidon should probably be assigned to this series, as the reverse type is the same. The

type of the head on the obverse is different from those given; it is very large, almost filling up the surface of the coin, and the horns cannot be seen on the forehead.

¹⁸⁸ An Olbian inscription found in 1900 (Lat. iv. 460), of the fourth century B.C., refers to archery contests held at Olbia. These must have been imitated from the Scythians, as Greeks in other places do not seem to have had them.

¹⁸⁹ Herod., iv. 18.

The purely Hellenic character of the religion of Olbia seems to be demonstrated by the facts above presented; there is no trace of any merely local god except the Borysthene, who is of course only an apparent exception, as the neighbouring river is a figure that constantly appears on the coins of Greek states. Local colour is supplied by the Scythian bow and arrows, and perhaps by the sturgeon; the other types can hardly be said to be in any way distinctive.

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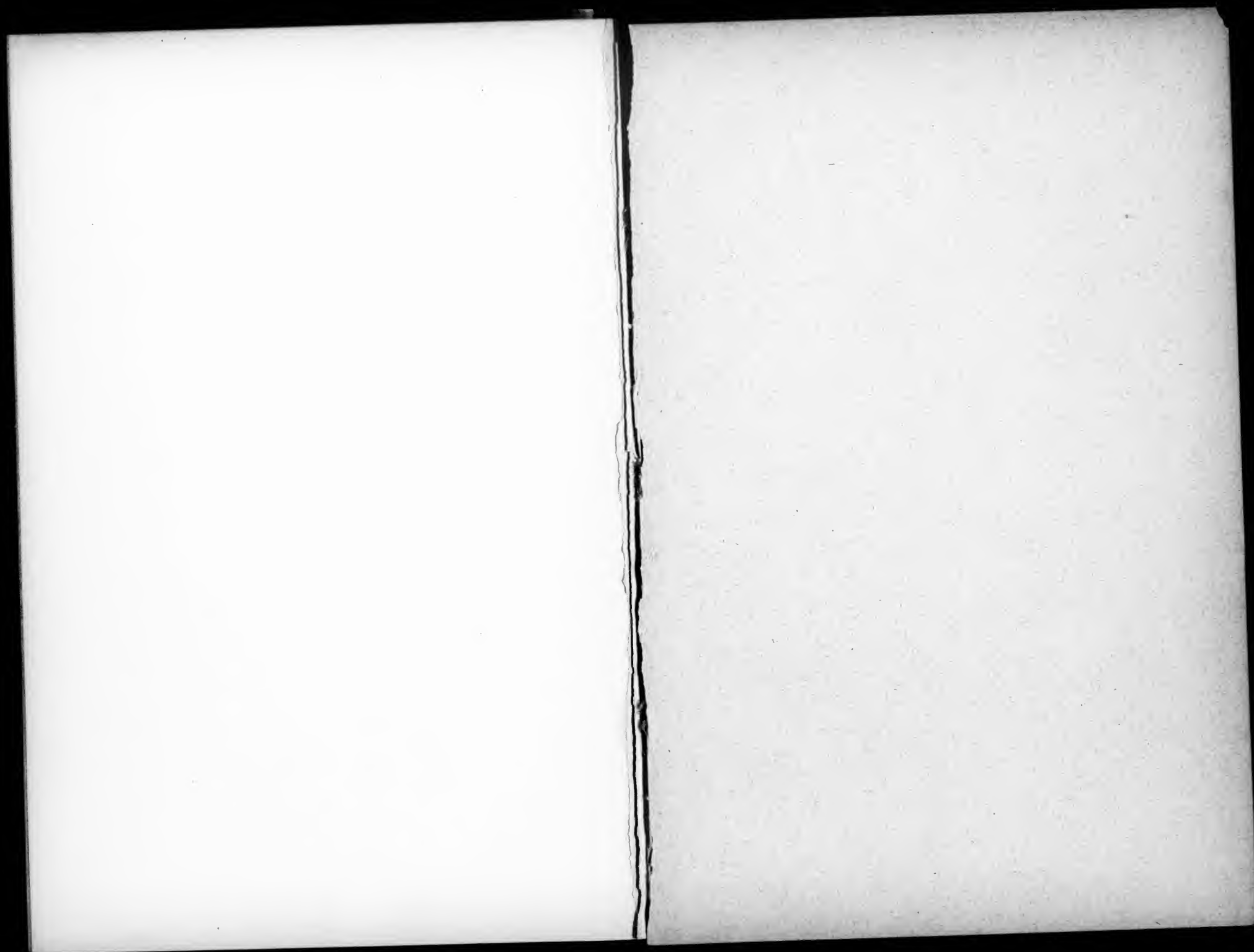
ERRATA

- P. 25, note 9, for B. C. H. v., 1880, read 1881.
- P. 29, note 42, for 1891, p. 338, read 388, and add: Latyshev, iv, 79.
- P. 44, line 4, for Tanais, read Tomi.
- P. 52, line 9, for piece of gold work, read electrum vase.
- P. 52, note 185, add: Ant. du Bosp. Cimm., Pl. xxxiii.
- P. 250, line 8, for ii. 153, read iii, p. 258.
- P. 256, note 51, for Real-Encycl., i, p. 54, read ii, p. 54.
- P. 259, note 65, for Gryphon, read Gryps.

VITA

Gertrude Mary Hirst was born at Huddersfield, England, and was privately educated until she entered Newnham College, Cambridge, where she was awarded the Drapers' Scholarship for distinction in Latin and Greek. She took honours in the Classical Tripos, Part I, in 1890. She remained for another year of work at Newnham, and in 1891 came to America, where she taught in Louisville, Kentucky, and afterwards in New York. In 1898 she became a graduate student of Columbia University, where she received the degree of Master of Arts in 1900, and of Doctor of Philosophy in 1902. While at Columbia she was under the instruction of Professors Perry, Egbert and Earle, and of Dr. Olcott. In 1901 she was appointed Assistant in Classical Philology at Barnard College, and in 1903 was promoted to the rank of Tutor. She is a member of the Society for the Promotion of Hellenic Studies, and of the American Philological Association.

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